



# General Music Curriculum

## Student Workbook

5th Grade



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# Developing Literacy and Math Skills through Music

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Hello, Music Educators! We are excited to partner with you to unlock language for all students, especially our Emergent Bilinguals. To support this, we've embedded three cross-curricular connections into your QuaverMusic Workbooks:

- **Literacy Connections:** Accelerate vocabulary acquisition and print awareness using Quaver's signature song library and activities.
- **Math Connections:** Explores the relationship between music and math through beat counting, patterns, and numerical structures.
- **Reading Comprehension Skills:** Strengthen literal and inferential comprehension through curated reading passages, featuring robust multiple-choice and open-ended response questions.

## Tips for Success in the Music Room

Use these strategies to help students navigate more complex texts:

1. **Analyze and Underline:** Encourage students to underline content-area vocabulary, like timbre or dynamics, as they read to help them locate answers quickly.
2. **Think-Pair-Share:** Have students discuss the prompt with a partner before they begin writing.
3. **Whisper-Read to Self:** When editing, have students whisper-read sentences. They will often hear a grammar error before they spot it visually.

## Make it Your Own!

- **Bell-Ringers:** Use a passage as a warm-up to focus the class on the day's concept.
- **Station Rotations:** These pages work as a quiet station while you work with small groups.
- **Home Connection:** Send pages home for students to complete.

We believe that every music lesson is an opportunity to strengthen a student's voice—both musically and academically. Thank you for all you do!

**Musically,  
The QuaverEd Team**

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# The Quaver Five

Learn the moves, then draw a line connecting the words below to their corresponding moves.



**Be Cooperative**

**Be Safe**

**Be Responsible**

**Be Kind**

**Be Polite**

## Class Rules

Write an example of how to follow one of the Quaver Five rules in music class.

**Example:** I can be responsible in music class by doing my best work.

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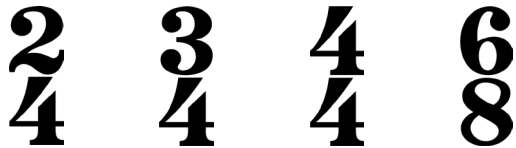
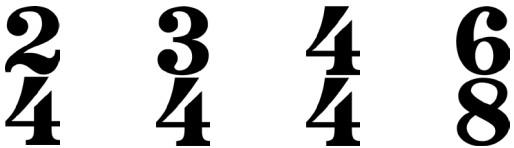
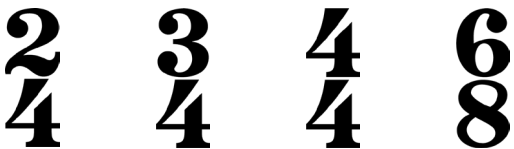
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## Which Meter Is It?

Listen to each example in Which Meter? and circle its corresponding meter sign.

|                                                                                               |                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1</b><br> | <b>2</b><br> |
| <b>3</b><br> | <b>4</b><br> |

Use the words in the word bank to complete the sentences below.

| Word Bank |      |     |      |        |       |          |
|-----------|------|-----|------|--------|-------|----------|
| meter     | note | one | sign | symbol | beats | measures |

- \_\_\_\_\_ is the organization of \_\_\_\_\_, usually into \_\_\_\_\_ of 2, 3, or 4 beats.
- A meter \_\_\_\_\_ is a musical \_\_\_\_\_ that tells you how many beats are in each measure and which \_\_\_\_\_ value equals \_\_\_\_\_ beat.

# Patriotic Music

Listen to each song, then respond to the questions.

## **"America (My Country, 'Tis of Thee)"**

1. What is the meter of this song? Circle one.

**$\frac{2}{4}$**

**$\frac{3}{4}$**

**$\frac{4}{4}$**

**$\frac{6}{8}$**

2. How does this song make you want to move? Circle one.

**March**

**Sway**

**Waltz**

3. What words would you use to describe this song?

\_\_\_\_\_

## **"You're a Grand Old Flag"**

1. What is the meter of this song? Circle one.

**$\frac{2}{4}$**

**$\frac{3}{4}$**

**$\frac{4}{4}$**

**$\frac{6}{8}$**

2. How does this song make you want to move? Circle one.

**March**

**Sway**

**Waltz**

3. What words would you use to describe this song?

\_\_\_\_\_

# All About Meter

Use the word bank to complete the sentences.  
(Hint: You may use a word more than once.)

## Word Bank

|              |                   |              |              |                   |                   |                   |
|--------------|-------------------|--------------|--------------|-------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| <b>meter</b> | <b>meter sign</b> | <b>march</b> | <b>waltz</b> | <b>meter of 2</b> | <b>meter of 3</b> | <b>meter of 4</b> |
|--------------|-------------------|--------------|--------------|-------------------|-------------------|-------------------|

1. A \_\_\_\_\_ is a musical symbol that tells you how many beats are in a measure and which beat equals one count.
2. The organization of beats into measures, usually of 2, 3, or 4 beats, is called \_\_\_\_\_.
3. In a \_\_\_\_\_, beats are organized in a pattern of three with one strong beat and two weak beats.
4. In a \_\_\_\_\_, beats are organized in a pattern of two with one strong beat and one weak beat.
5. In a \_\_\_\_\_, beats are organized in a pattern of four with one strong beat and three weak beats.
6. A meter of 2 works well for a \_\_\_\_\_.
7. A meter of 3 works well for a \_\_\_\_\_.

## Practicing 6/8 Meter

Fill in the blanks to complete the sentence.

**6/8** meter means there are \_\_\_\_\_  
beats in each measure and an   
equals \_\_\_\_\_ beat.



Create a 6/8 groove by choosing from the rhythms below and writing one in each box.  
Practice clapping, counting, and saying each rhythm.

|            |             |             |
|------------|-------------|-------------|
| <b>6/8</b> | <div></div> | <div></div> |
| <b>6/8</b> | <div></div> | <div></div> |



# Meter Assessment

Choose the letter that best answers each question.

**1** The Quaver Five reminds us to be \_\_\_\_ .

- |                                                               |                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> safe, sarcastic, quiet, smart,<br>and melodic       | <b>B.</b> polite, happy, puzzled,<br>rhythmic, and silly               |
| <b>C.</b> safe, polite, cooperative,<br>responsible, and kind | <b>D.</b> safe, polymorphic, corresponding,<br>reasonable, and kindred |

**2** In music, a meter is \_\_\_\_ .

- |                                                                             |                                                                                   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> an instrument that shows how<br>much electricity your family uses | <b>B.</b> a sign that tells you the tempo<br>of the music                         |
| <b>C.</b> a sign that tells you how loud or<br>soft to play the music       | <b>D.</b> the organization of beats, usually<br>into measures of 2, 3, or 4 beats |

**3** A 2/2 meter indicates that there are \_\_\_\_ beats per measure and the \_\_\_\_ equals one beat.

- |                           |                          |
|---------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> 2, half note    | <b>B.</b> 4, half note   |
| <b>C.</b> 3, quarter note | <b>D.</b> 2, eighth note |

**4** A 6/8 meter indicates that there are \_\_\_\_ beats per measure and the \_\_\_\_ equals one beat.

- |                           |                          |
|---------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> 20, whole note  | <b>B.</b> 6, eighth note |
| <b>C.</b> 2, quarter note | <b>D.</b> 4, half note   |

**5** Listen carefully. This song is in a meter of \_\_\_\_ .

*This question uses an audio example. The teacher will trigger the audio example from the screen.*

- |             |             |
|-------------|-------------|
| <b>A.</b> 3 | <b>B.</b> 6 |
| <b>C.</b> 5 | <b>D.</b> 2 |



## Literacy Connection

Write a short phrase or sentence that could be in a patriotic song.

Think about words like **freedom**, **bravery**, and **unity**!

“

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”



Now, clap the rhythm of your phrase.

Does it fit into **simple meter (2/4, 3/4, 4/4)** or **6/8 meter**?

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If you could write a new patriotic song, what would it be about?

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## Math Connection

Ask your classmates about their favorite patriotic song and tally their responses to find which song is the most popular.

**Bonus: What fraction of students chose “The Star-Spangled Banner”?**

| Song Title               | Tally | Total |
|--------------------------|-------|-------|
| The Star-Spangled Banner |       |       |
| America the Beautiful    |       |       |
| My Country, 'Tis of Thee |       |       |
| God Bless America        |       |       |



Which song is the most popular? \_\_\_\_\_

### Challenge

If a drummer plays a steady beat in 6/8 time, how many beats would they play in 4 measures? Show your work!

# Reading Comprehension Skills

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## Understanding Meter

- 1.** Have you ever instinctively tapped your foot to the pulse of a song? That consistent feeling is the beat. Beat is the heartbeat of music. Most music follows a systematic pattern called meter. Meter is the method musicians use to organize beats into recurring groups.
- 2.** Think of meter as the skeleton of a song. In every group, the first beat is the strong beat, while the others are weak beats. To keep these patterns organized, composers use bar lines. These are vertical lines that act like fences, dividing the music into units called measures.
- 3.** At the beginning of a musical score, you will find the time signature, also called a meter sign. This symbol consists of two stacked numbers. The top number indicates how many beats are in each measure, while the bottom number determines which note value acts as the unit for a single beat.
- 4.** While patterns vary, three types of meter are pervasive:
  - Duple Meter (2/4): A grouping of two beats that provides a driving pulse for polkas or fast dances.
  - Triple Meter (3/4): This creates a graceful, spinning sensation, famous in the waltz.
  - Quadruple Meter (4/4): Used so often in Western music that it is nicknamed "common time." It feels like a steady walk and is often used in pop and rock.

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## Comprehension Questions

**1** The author describes the beat as the heartbeat of a song. Based on the context of paragraph 1, what does this figurative language imply about the beat?

- |                                                                          |                                                                          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> It is the part of the music that sounds the loudest.           | <b>B.</b> It is a constant, necessary pulse that keeps the music moving. |
| <b>C.</b> It is a sound that changes speed whenever the singer breathes. | <b>D.</b> It is a fast rhythm used only in energetic dance music.        |

**2** Which meter would a composer most likely use to create the spinning feeling of a waltz?

- |                                 |                              |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Duple Meter (2/4)     | <b>B.</b> Triple Meter (3/4) |
| <b>C.</b> Quadruple Meter (4/4) | <b>D.</b> Common Time (4/4)  |

**3** In paragraph 2, the author says bar lines “act like fences.” This descriptive language helps the reader understand that bar lines \_\_\_\_.

- |                                                                  |                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> protect the music from being stolen by other musicians | <b>B.</b> are the tallest symbols found on a musical staff      |
| <b>C.</b> represent the highest and lowest pitches in a measure  | <b>D.</b> mark the boundaries between different groups of beats |

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

**4** This item has two parts. Answer Part A, then answer Part B.

**Part A: What is the significance of the top number in a time signature?**

- |                                                                   |                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> It dictates the speed or tempo of the marching rhythm.  | <b>B.</b> It defines which note value represents one full beat.            |
| <b>C.</b> It indicates the total number of beats in each measure. | <b>D.</b> It marks the location of the very first strong beat in the song. |

**Part B: Which sentence from the passage best supports the answer to Part A?**

- |                                                                               |                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> "The first beat in the group is always the strongest..."            | <b>B.</b> "The top number indicates how many beats are in each measure..." |
| <b>C.</b> "The bottom number determines which note value acts as the unit..." | <b>D.</b> "Everything between two bar lines is one measure."               |

**5** The author compares bar lines to fences and meter to a skeleton. Choose one of these examples of descriptive language and explain how it helps you understand a musical concept. Be sure to use complete sentences and follow conventional spelling rules.

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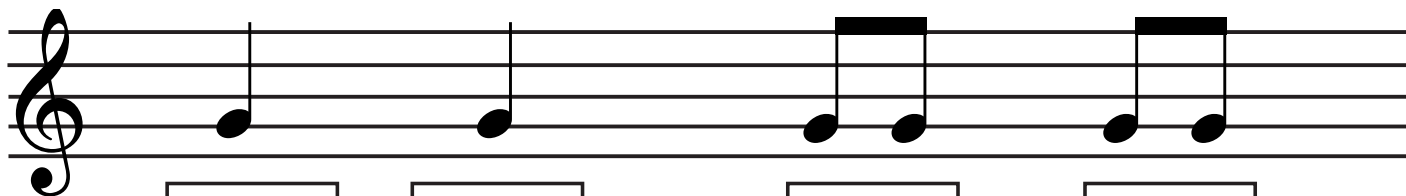
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# Rhythmic Syllables

Write the rhythm syllables in the boxes using a preferred counting method.



Four empty boxes for writing rhythm syllables.



Four empty boxes for writing rhythm syllables.



Four empty boxes for writing rhythm syllables.



Four empty boxes for writing rhythm syllables.

# Reggae Recap

Write the answer to each question below.

**1.** In what meter is reggae music often played?

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**2.** Which beats are usually accented in reggae music?

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**3.** How many chords does reggae music typically use?

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**4.** Which instrument does the keyboard frequently copy in reggae music?

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# Syncopation

Fill in the blanks to complete the definition.



Syncopation is the placement of \_\_\_\_\_ rhythms or accents where they wouldn't normally occur, such as on the \_\_\_\_\_ beats or off-beats.

## Syncopation in a Song

Listen to the song from Syncopation in a Song and circle the beats on which you hear the syncopated guitar rhythm.





## Train the Brain - Reggae

Using the word bank, write each vocabulary word in the box next to its correct definition.

### Word Bank

**backbeat**

**unity**

**chords**

**injustice**

### Definition

### Vocabulary Word

**a violation of the rights of others**

**being together as one**

**emphasizing beats 2 and 4**

**combinations of three or more notes  
played together**

# What Does the Dot Tell Us?

Write the correct number in the blank to complete each statement.

1. Half note  = \_\_\_\_\_ beat(s)

2. Half of half note  = \_\_\_\_\_ beat(s)

3. Dotted half note  = \_\_\_\_\_ beat(s)

4. Quarter note  = \_\_\_\_\_ beat(s)

5. Half of quarter note  = \_\_\_\_\_ beat(s)

6. Dotted quarter note  = \_\_\_\_\_ beat(s)

7. Eighth note  = \_\_\_\_\_ beat(s)

8. Half of eighth note  = \_\_\_\_\_ beat(s)

9. Dotted eighth note  = \_\_\_\_\_ beat(s)

10.  =  = \_\_\_\_\_ beat(s)

11.  =  = \_\_\_\_\_ beat(s)

# Rhythm Assessment

Choose the letter that best answers each question.

**1** Syncopation, guitar “dead-picking” on off-beats, strong backbeats, and a focus on love and social equality all describe \_\_\_\_\_ music.

A. classical

B. reggae

C. rock

D. country

**2** Placement of rhythms or accents where they wouldn’t normally occur, such as on weak beats, is \_\_\_\_\_.

A. mutation

B. transcription

C. notation

D. syncopation

**3** Listen and select the example using syncopation.

*This question uses an audio example. The teacher will trigger the audio example from the screen.*

A. Example 1

B. Example 2

C. Example 3

D. Example 4

**4** Listen carefully. Which one is an example of reggae music?

*This question uses an audio example. The teacher will trigger the audio example from the screen.*

A. Example 1

B. Example 2

C. Example 3

D. Example 4

**5** Listen to one measure of rhythm. Which written notation below matches?

A. 

B. 

C. 

D. 

# Literacy Connection

Think about a problem you care about. It can be a **big problem** or a **small one**!

## Examples:

- Bullying
- Pollution
- Pineapple on pizza
- Cats vs. dogs
- Losing your socks

## My topic is:

---

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## Why Does It Matter?

Tell why your topic is important or interesting.

I think this matters because: \_\_\_\_\_

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## Write lyrics or fun lines for a song about your topic.

My song lyrics might say: \_\_\_\_\_

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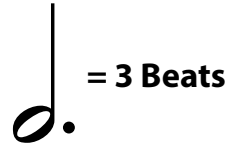
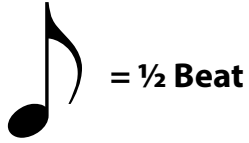
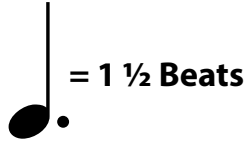
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**Name:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Math Connection

Use the note values below to make each measure equal 4 total beats. You may use each note more than once. Write the note name in the first blanks. Then write an equation for each measure.



**quarter note**

**dotted quarter note**

**eighth note**

half note

**dotted half note**

**Measure 1:** \_\_\_\_\_ + \_\_\_\_\_ = 4 beats  
note name note name

**Equation:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Measure 2:** \_\_\_\_\_ + \_\_\_\_\_ = 4 beats  
note name note name

**Equation:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Measure 3:** \_\_\_\_\_ + \_\_\_\_\_ + \_\_\_\_\_ + \_\_\_\_\_ = **4 beats**  
                     note name                      note name                      note name                      note name

**Equation:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Measure 4:** \_\_\_\_\_ + \_\_\_\_\_ + \_\_\_\_\_ + \_\_\_\_\_ = **4 beats**  
                     note name                      note name                      note name                      note name

**Equation:**

## Challenge

Create your own 4-beat measure using **at least one dotted note**.

**Your notes:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Equation:** \_\_\_\_\_

# Reading Comprehension Skills

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## Syncopation and Reggae Music

1. Reggae music is known for its groovy and surprising rhythms. One important rhythmic idea that helps give reggae its special sound is syncopation. Syncopation makes the music feel relaxed but exciting at the same time.
2. Syncopation is the placement of rhythms or accents where they wouldn't normally occur, such as on the weak beats or off-beats. Instead of stressing the main beats, syncopation often highlights the offbeats, which makes the music feel exciting and lively.
3. Reggae is a popular form of music that originated in Jamaica and became popular during the 1960s. In reggae, musicians often stress the second and fourth beats in a measure instead of the first and third. This rhythm is sometimes called the "skank," and it is usually played with the guitar or keyboard.
4. Syncopation in reggae is not just about sound—it also connects to Jamaican culture and history. Reggae music was influenced by African rhythms and Caribbean traditions. Many reggae songs share messages about peace, fairness, and community. The strong offbeat rhythm helps reggae music feel relaxed but powerful at the same time.

## Comprehension Questions

### 1 What is syncopation?

- |                                       |                                              |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Playing music very fast     | <b>B.</b> Emphasizing unexpected or offbeats |
| <b>C.</b> Singing without instruments | <b>D.</b> Using only drums in music          |

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## 2 Which beats are often emphasized in reggae music?

- |                            |                        |
|----------------------------|------------------------|
| A. First and third beats   | B. Only the first beat |
| C. Second and fourth beats | D. Every beat equally  |

## 3 What does the word “offbeats” mean as used in the passage?

- |                                         |                               |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| A. Beats that are louder and exciting   | B. Beats that are expected    |
| C. Beats that are weaker and unexpected | D. Beats played by drums only |

## 4 Which part of the word “syncopation” shows the /sh/ sound?

- |        |         |
|--------|---------|
| A. syn | B. co   |
| C. pa  | D. tion |

## 5 Why is syncopation important in reggae music? Use at least one detail from the passage to support your answer.

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# SATB Music and Clefs

Use the word bank to complete the sentences.  
(Hint: You may use a word more than once.)

| Word Bank |        |         |       |      |        |      |       |
|-----------|--------|---------|-------|------|--------|------|-------|
| bass      | unison | soprano | range | part | treble | alto | tenor |

1. The lowest to highest pitch that can be sung or played by a voice or instrument is called its \_\_\_\_\_.
2. A musical sign to indicate lower pitches on the staff is called a \_\_\_\_\_ clef.
3. When all voice parts sing the same pitches and rhythms at the same time, it is called \_\_\_\_\_ singing.
4. When voice parts sing different pitches and rhythms to create harmony, it is called \_\_\_\_\_-singing.
5. The bass voice part, tuba, and double bass read \_\_\_\_\_ clef.
6. The soprano voice part, flute, and violin read \_\_\_\_\_ clef.
7. The four different voices used in SATB music, in order from high to low, are called \_\_\_\_\_, \_\_\_\_\_, \_\_\_\_\_, and \_\_\_\_\_.



# Treble Clef Pitches

Write the pitches in the boxes below each note for the descant part of "Get on Board."

## Descant

## Get on Board

2 8 2nd X only

Get on board, chil - dren.

Get on board, chil - dren.

Get on board, chil - dren.

there's room for more!

Get on board, chil - dren.

Get on board, chil - dren.

board, chil - dren, there's room for more!

# Descant Review

Put a **T** next to true statements about descants and an **F** next to false ones.

1. \_\_\_\_\_ A descant is an extra melody part that is higher than the main melody.
2. \_\_\_\_\_ A descant adds beauty and interest to a piece of music.
3. \_\_\_\_\_ A descant is most commonly sung by bass voices in an SATB choir.
4. \_\_\_\_\_ A descant typically has fewer singers than the main melody.
5. \_\_\_\_\_ A descant is most commonly sung by soprano voices in an SATB choir.
6. \_\_\_\_\_ Every song must have a descant.



# Chinese Instruments: Pipa and Erhu Fact-Finder

Watch Quaver's video, *How to Play the Pipa and the Erhu*, then answer the questions below.

1. The pipa and the erhu are in which instrument family? \_\_\_\_\_
2. How many strings does the erhu have? \_\_\_\_\_
3. The erhu is played with a \_\_\_\_\_.
4. What type of skin is used on the erhu? \_\_\_\_\_
5. What orchestral instrument is closest to the erhu? \_\_\_\_\_
6. To play the pipa, what do you need to put on your fingers? \_\_\_\_\_
7. What is the technique called when you use your fingers in order to pluck the strings of the pipa? \_\_\_\_\_
8. The strings of the pipa were originally made of \_\_\_\_\_ ,  
but now they are made of \_\_\_\_\_.



# Singing Assessment

Choose the letter that best answers each question.

## 1 What are the names of the four different singing voices?

- |                                           |                                                  |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Soprano, alternate, tempo, bass | <b>B.</b> Forte, mezzo forte, mezzo piano, piano |
| <b>C.</b> Sonata, alto, tenuto, bass      | <b>D.</b> Soprano, alto, tenor, bass             |

## 2 \_\_\_\_\_ is the lowest to highest pitch that can be sung or played.

- |                     |                   |
|---------------------|-------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Bass clef | <b>B.</b> Descant |
| <b>C.</b> Soprano   | <b>D.</b> Range   |

## 3 What type of music is this?

*This question uses an audio example. The teacher will trigger the audio example from the screen.*

- |                                      |                  |
|--------------------------------------|------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Soprano, alto, tenor, bass | <b>B.</b> Unison |
| <b>C.</b> Melody with descant        | <b>D.</b> Rap    |

## 4 Which of these instruments / voices reads notes in the bass clef?

- |                                              |                                               |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Soprano, piccolo, soprano recorder | <b>B.</b> Bass, tuba, double bass             |
| <b>C.</b> Alto, alto saxophone, clarinet     | <b>D.</b> Tenor, tenor saxophone, French horn |

## 5 Traditional Chinese music uses the \_\_\_\_\_.

- |                  |                           |
|------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> violin | <b>B.</b> erhu            |
| <b>C.</b> tuba   | <b>D.</b> electric guitar |

# Literacy Connection

Read this excerpt from the spiritual “Swing Low, Sweet Chariot.”

“Swing low, sweet chariot,  
coming for to carry me home.  
Swing low, sweet chariot,  
coming for to carry me home.”

1. What is the “chariot” literally doing in the song?

\_\_\_\_\_

2. What might “carry me home” literally mean?

\_\_\_\_\_

**This song was sung by people who were enslaved in the United States. They often used spirituals to express emotions, hope, and even secret messages.**

3. What might the “chariot” represent beyond the literal meaning?

\_\_\_\_\_

4. What could “home” mean to someone who was enslaved?

\_\_\_\_\_

5. Why do you think spirituals like this one used double meanings?

\_\_\_\_\_

# Math Connection

Use the choral information provided to solve each math problem.

## A school choir has these voice parts:

**12 Sopranos****9 Altos****6 Tenors****3 Basses**

1. How many singers are in the choir altogether?

\_\_\_\_ + \_\_\_\_ + \_\_\_\_ + \_\_\_\_ = \_\_\_\_\_ **singers**

2. What fraction of the choir are: (*Write your answer as a fraction of the total number of singers.*)

**Sopranos?** \_\_\_\_\_

**Altos?** \_\_\_\_\_

**Tenors?** \_\_\_\_\_

**Basses?** \_\_\_\_\_

3. Which two voice parts make up half of the choir when put together?

**A.** Soprano + Alto      **B.** Alto + Tenor      **C.** Tenor + Bass

4. Each row on the risers can hold six singers. How many rows does each voice part need?

**Sopranos:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Altos:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Tenors:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Basses:** \_\_\_\_\_

5. Which group needs the most rows? \_\_\_\_\_

# Reading Comprehension Skills

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## The Soloist's Choice

1. I stood in the wings of the auditorium, clutching my sheet music so tightly the corners began to curl. My music teacher, Mr. Henderson, peered at me through his thick glasses. He noticed my shaking hands and whispered, "Remember, Maya, your vocal range is perfect for this song. Just breathe."
2. I nodded, but my stomach felt like it was doing gymnastics. Earlier that morning, my classmate Leo had smirked at me in the hallway. "That song has too many leaps," he had warned, referring to the large intervals between notes. "You'll never hit the high C." His words played on a loop in my head, creating a sharp conflict between my confidence and my fear.
3. The auditorium went silent. This was the school-wide spring recital! I stepped onto the stage, the spotlight blinding me like an afternoon sun. As the piano player began the introduction, I saw Leo sitting in the front row, crossing his arms. I took a deep breath, shifted my focus to the back of the room, and let the first note soar.
4. The high C didn't just happen; it rang out clearly, vibrating through the air. The tension in my hands vanished as the final chorus came to a close. When the last chord faded, the room erupted in applause. Mr. Henderson beamed from the side of the stage, and even Leo was standing up clapping. Walking off stage, I realized the resolution wasn't just finishing the song. The resolution was finally silencing the doubt Leo had planted in my mind.

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## Comprehension Questions

### 1 What is the most likely reason the author wrote this story?

- |                                                                     |                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> To explain the scientific way vocal folds produce sound   | <b>B.</b> To describe a character's experience overcoming a challenge during a performance |
| <b>C.</b> To identify the best songs for a 5th-grade spring recital | <b>D.</b> To compare the difficulty of piano music versus vocal music                      |

### 2 Read this dictionary entry for the word range.

**range** \ˈrānj\ *noun*

- |                                                        |                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1.</b> a row of mountains or hills                  | <b>2.</b> an open area of land for animals to graze |
| <b>3.</b> the distance between the limits of something | <b>4.</b> a stove used for cooking food             |

**Which definition most closely fits the way the word range is used in paragraph 1?**

- |                        |                        |
|------------------------|------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Definition 1 | <b>B.</b> Definition 2 |
| <b>C.</b> Definition 3 | <b>D.</b> Definition 4 |

### 3 The author tells the story from the first-person point of view to help the reader understand \_\_\_\_.

- |                                                                      |                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Mr. Henderson's secret thoughts about Maya's talent        | <b>B.</b> how the audience feels about the piano player      |
| <b>C.</b> Maya's internal feelings and her reaction to Leo's comment | <b>D.</b> why Leo decided to attend the recital that evening |



# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

**4**

*This item has two parts. Answer Part A, then answer Part B.*

**Part A: What is the main conflict between Maya and Leo in the story?**

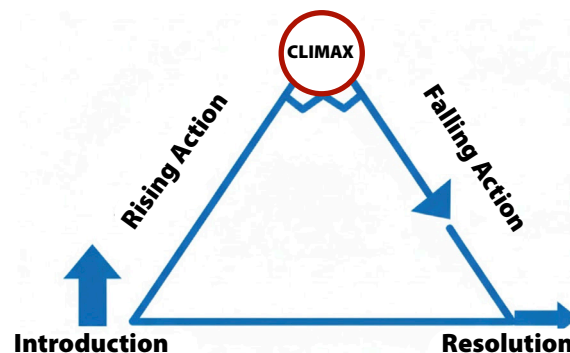
- |                                                                           |                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> They are both trying to win the same trophy from Mr. Henderson. | <b>B.</b> Leo believes Maya's vocal range is not strong enough for the song's leaps. |
| <b>C.</b> Maya is upset because Leo arrived late to the auditorium.       | <b>D.</b> Leo is angry that Maya chose a song with a high C.                         |

**Part B: Which sentence from the story best supports the answer to Part A?**

- |                                                                                      |                                                                    |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> "My music teacher, Mr. Henderson, peered at me through his thick glasses." | <b>B.</b> "Leo had smirked at me in the hallway."                  |
| <b>C.</b> "You'll never hit the high C, he had warned..."                            | <b>D.</b> "I saw Leo sitting in the front row, crossing his arms." |

**5**

**Identify the climax of the story and explain how the resolution shows a change in Maya's feelings. Use the terms vocal range and climax in your answer. Refer to the diagram if needed. Be sure to use correct capitalization, punctuation, and subject-verb agreement.**



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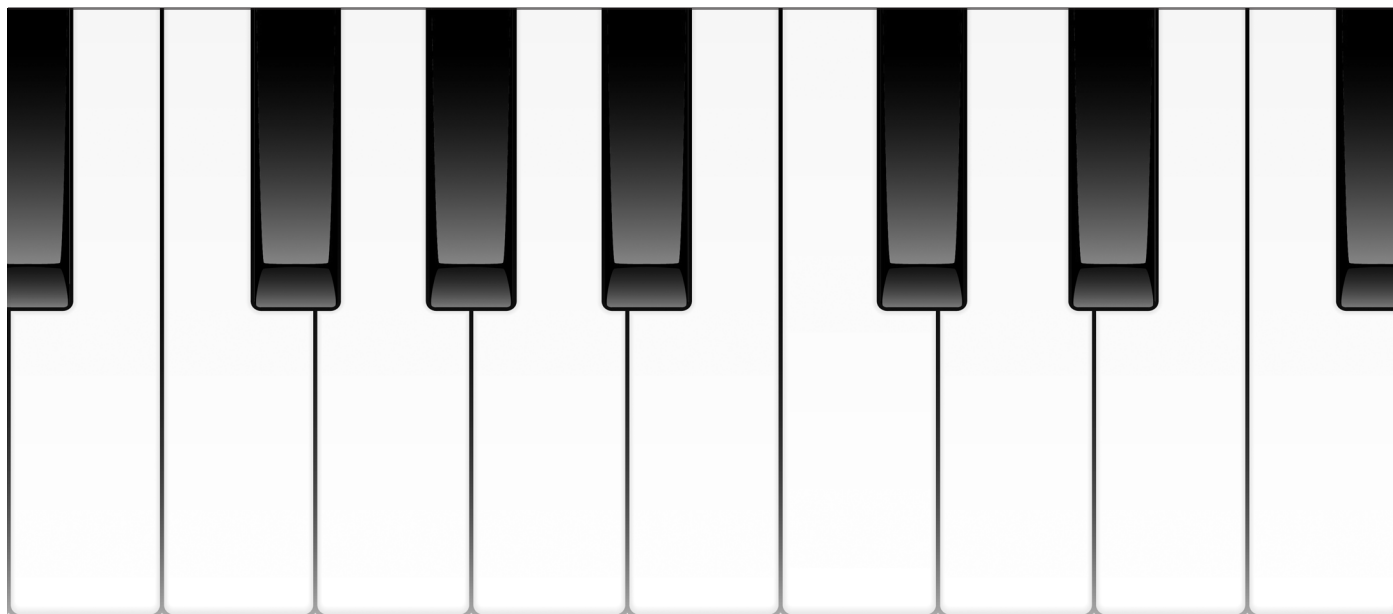
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# Half Steps

Fill in the blank to complete the definition.

**Half Step: The \_\_\_\_\_ movement that  
can happen between two notes**

Label a half step on the piano keys by drawing a line from one key to another key a half step away.



# Sharps, Flats, and Naturals

Fill in the blanks to complete the definitions.



**Sharp: A musical symbol placed before a note to \_\_\_\_\_ the pitch by one half step**



**Flat: A musical symbol placed before a note to \_\_\_\_\_ the pitch by one half step**



**Natural: A musical symbol placed before a note to \_\_\_\_\_ a sharp or a flat and return the pitch to normal**

## Half Steps Up and Down

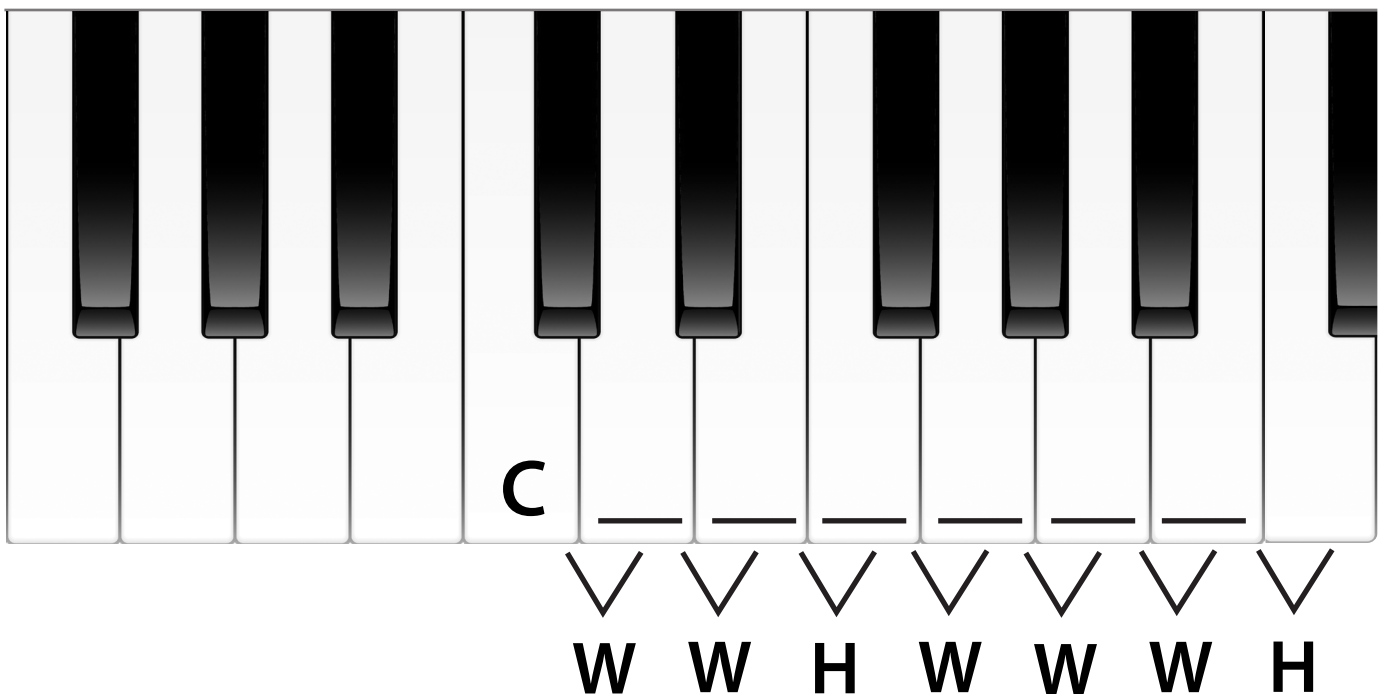
Add sharps or flats to fill in the half steps between the pitches on the second staff.



## C Major Scale

1. Label a whole step between any two keys on the piano below.
2. Write the pitches of a C major scale on the piano keys, following the pattern of whole and half steps.

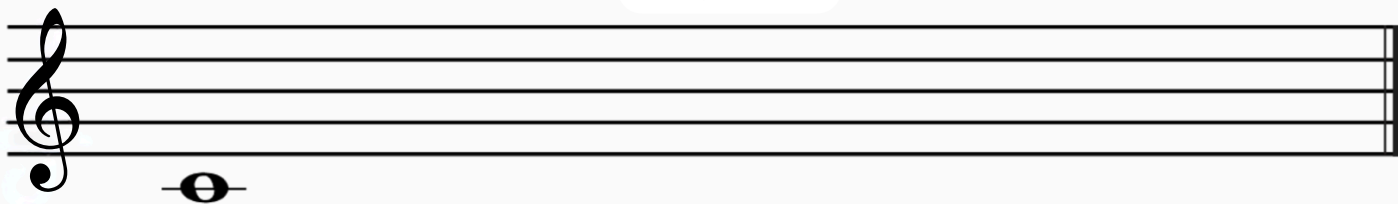
**Whole Step:**  
**An interval of \_\_\_\_\_ half steps**



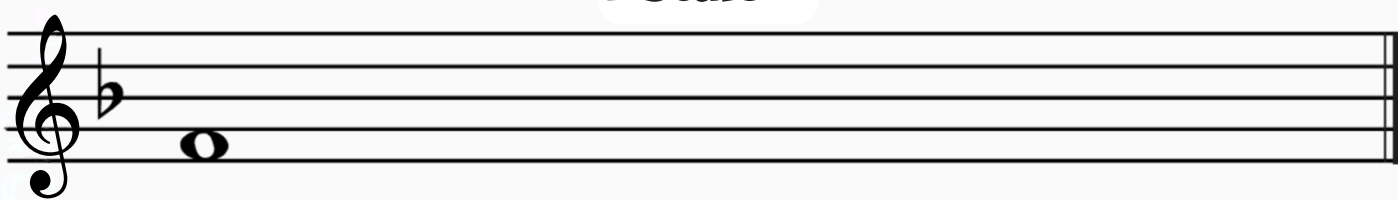
# Notating C, F, and G Major Scales

Notate the C, F, and G major scales on the music staff.

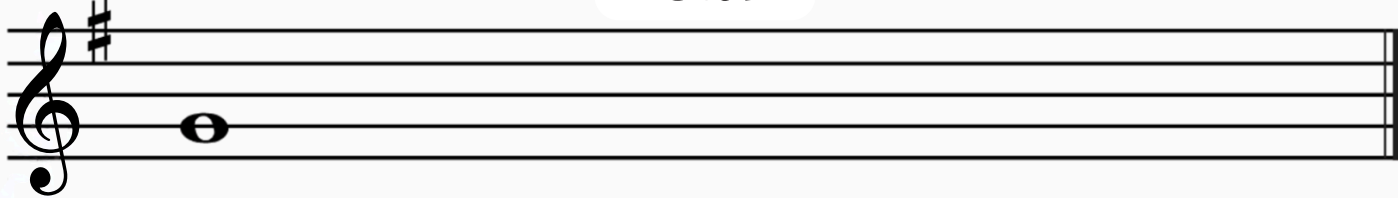
## C Scale



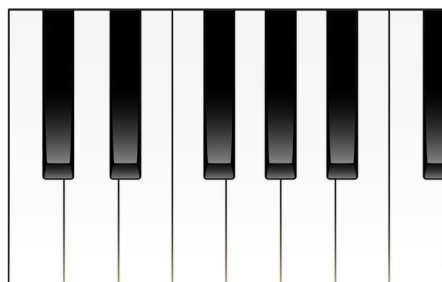
## F Scale



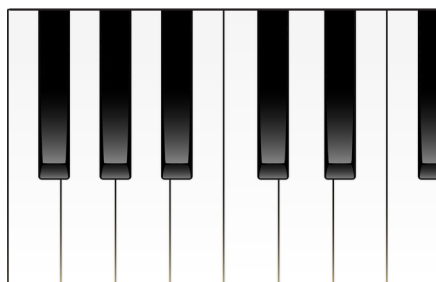
## G Scale



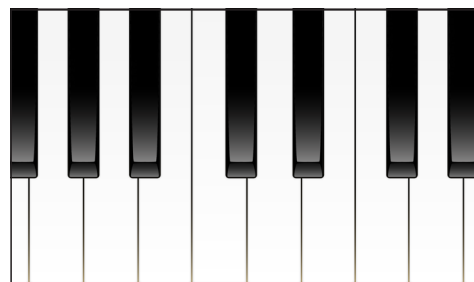
On the piano keys, draw a circle on every key used in the scale.



C Major



F Major



G Major

# All About Improvising

Fill in the blanks to complete the definition.

## Improvisation means...

\_\_\_\_\_ **music on the** \_\_\_\_\_ .

Circle the correct answer.

**What style of music is most associated with improvisation?**

- A.** Classical
- B.** Jazz
- C.** Country
- D.** Folk

**If improvising based on the G major scale, which of these notes would fit the scale?**

- A.** F sharp
- B.** A flat
- C.** C sharp
- D.** B flat

# Melody Assessment

Choose the letter that best answers each question.

**1** A scale consisting of steps W-W-H-W-W-W-H is a \_\_\_\_\_.

A. whole tone scale

B. mixolydian scale

C. major scale

D. pentatonic scale

**2** A(n) \_\_\_\_\_ is a symbol placed before a note to raise its pitch by one half step.

A. flat

B. key signature

C. accent

D. sharp

**3** A whole step is made up of \_\_\_\_\_.

A. two half steps

B. a C major scale

C. one flat

D. G-A-B-C-D-E-F#-G

**4** A flat is \_\_\_\_\_.

A. a combination of half notes

B. a musical symbol placed before a note to lower its pitch by one half step

C. the smallest movement that can happen between notes

D. when your car tire is out of air

**5** The F major scale has \_\_\_\_\_.

A. three flats

B. one flat

C. two naturals

D. one sharp



# Literacy Connection

Listen to each piece of music your teacher plays from the Moody Compositions Playlist. As you listen, close your eyes and imagine the colors you see, the shapes or scenes that come to mind, and how the music makes you feel. Draw what you imagined in the box provided, then write about it.

## Music Clip #1

**My Drawing:****My Thoughts:**

This music made me think of:

---

I used these colors/shapes because:

---

## Music Clip #2

**My Drawing:****My Thoughts:**

This music made me think of:

---

I used these colors/shapes because:

---

## Music Clip #3

**My Drawing:****My Thoughts:**

This music made me think of:

---

I used these colors/shapes because:

---

# Math Connection

Assign a body percussion movement to each type of note.

**(For example: clap = quarter note, stomp = half note.)**

Then improvise an 8-beat rhythm using your body percussion ideas!

| Note         | Symbol | My Body Percussion |
|--------------|--------|--------------------|
| Whole Note   |        |                    |
| Half Note    |        |                    |
| Quarter Note |        |                    |
| Eighth Notes |        |                    |

Use this line to write down your rhythm ideas!

|  |  |
|--|--|
|  |  |
|--|--|

## Practice and Perform

- Practice your rhythm using your body percussion choices.
- Try performing it for a partner or small group.
- Keep a steady beat—use a metronome or background music if you like!

## Bonus Creativity Challenge:

- Create a second 8-beat rhythm using different note values.
- Try performing both patterns one after the other—or combine with a friend!

# Reading Comprehension Skills

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## The Path of a Melody

1. Have you ever hummed a tune that you made up on the spot? If so, you were improvising a melody. In music, to improvise means to create music instantly rather than reading it from a page. While it sounds like “making it up,” musicians actually use a specific set of pitches, called a scale, to guide their creative choices. A scale acts as a musical alphabet that ensures the pitches fit together.
2. One common scale used for improvisation is the G major scale. This scale starts and ends on the pitch G and includes one pitch that is sharp: F sharp. When a musician chooses to build a new melody within this scale, they sing or play specific pitches in an intentional order to create a musical idea. By starting and ending on the home tone of G, the melody feels complete to the listener.
3. Musicians can evaluate their improvisations to improve their skills. For example, if a pitch sounded “off” because it was not part of the chosen scale, they can avoid that pitch next time. The more musicians explore the pitches in a scale, the more they discover certain combinations of pitches that flow well together. They can use these combinations in future improvisations. This cycle of creating, discovering, and reusing combinations of pitches is how improvisers use the scale to create memorable melodies in the moment. Understanding the structure of a scale is the key to improvising melodies.

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## Comprehension Questions

### 1 What is the most likely reason the author wrote this article?

- |                                                                         |                                                                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> To explain how to memorize lyrics to a song                   | <b>B.</b> To explain how scales help musicians to improvise melodies         |
| <b>C.</b> To identify which instruments are the loudest in an orchestra | <b>D.</b> To compare the history of famous melodies from different countries |

### 2 Read this dictionary entry for the word “explore”.

**explore** /ik-ˈsplɔr/ verb

- |                                                                  |                                                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1.</b> to look around carefully to learn more about something | <b>2.</b> to try different ideas or choices to discover what works best |
| <b>3.</b> to travel through a place to see what is there         | <b>4.</b> to search for information about a topic                       |

**Which definition most closely fits the way the word explore is used in paragraph 3?**

- |                        |                        |
|------------------------|------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Definition 1 | <b>B.</b> Definition 2 |
| <b>C.</b> Definition 3 | <b>D.</b> Definition 4 |

### 3 Based on the text, which TWO steps are part of the process of creating an improvised melody?

- |                                                                         |                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Choosing pitches from a specific scale, such as G Major       | <b>B.</b> Copying a melody exactly as it is written on sheet music |
| <b>C.</b> Evaluating a melody after it is played to improve your skills | <b>D.</b> Asking an audience to vote on their favorite note        |
| <b>E.</b> Writing a long essay about the history of the note F-sharp    |                                                                    |

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

**4**

*This item has two parts. Answer Part A, then answer Part B.*

**Part A: What is the central idea of the article?**

- |                                                                             |                                                                             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Improvisation is a random act that does not require practice.     | <b>B.</b> Musicians use scales as a framework to creatively build melodies. |
| <b>C.</b> The G Major scale is the only scale that can be used for humming. | <b>D.</b> High notes are more important than low notes in a melody.         |

**Part B: Which sentence from the passage best supports the answer to Part A?**

- |                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> "Have you ever hummed a tune that you made up on the spot?"                        | <b>B.</b> "While it sounds like 'making it up,' musicians actually use a specific set of pitches, called a scale, to guide their creative choices." |
| <b>C.</b> "This scale starts and ends on the note G and includes one special note: F-sharp." | <b>D.</b> "This cycle of creating and improving is how original melodies are born."                                                                 |

**5**

**Summarize how musicians use scales to improvise melodies and improve their skills over time. Be sure to use details from the text and apply correct sound-letter relationships when spelling musical terms.**

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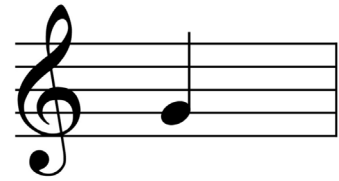
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# Identifying Notes and Rests

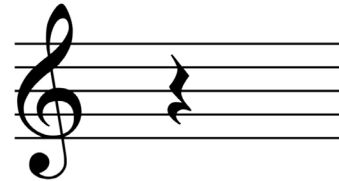
Fill in the correct box for each note or rest.



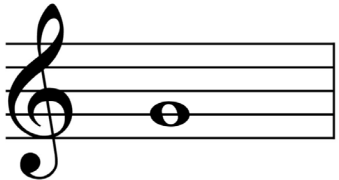
☐ Whole rest  
☐ Half rest  
☐ Quarter rest  
☐ Eighth rest



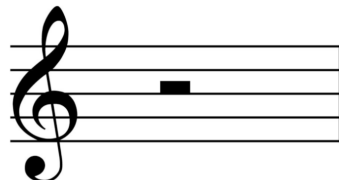
☐ Whole note  
☐ Half note  
☐ Quarter note  
☐ Eighth note



☐ Whole rest  
☐ Half rest  
☐ Quarter rest  
☐ Eighth rest



☐ Whole note  
☐ Half note  
☐ Quarter note  
☐ Eighth note



☐ Whole rest  
☐ Half rest  
☐ Quarter rest  
☐ Eighth rest



☐ Whole note  
☐ Half note  
☐ Quarter note  
☐ Eighth note

## Middle C and the Grand Staff

Watch the *Middle C and the Grand Staff* episode, then answer the following questions.

1. Where are notes placed? \_\_\_\_\_
2. Which symbols are placed at the beginning of the grand staff? \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_
3. Which note is suspended between the staves? \_\_\_\_\_

## Notation Symbol Recap

Fill in the blanks to complete the statements.

### Da Capo (D.C.) al Fine:

Go back to the \_\_\_\_\_, and stop at the \_\_\_\_\_

*D.C. al Fine*

### Dal Segno (D.S.) al Fine:

Go from the \_\_\_\_\_ to the \_\_\_\_\_ — usually the  
sign does not go back to the \_\_\_\_\_ of the song



The grand staff is divided into the \_\_\_\_\_ clef and the \_\_\_\_\_ clef.

Each clef has \_\_\_\_\_ lines and \_\_\_\_\_ spaces.

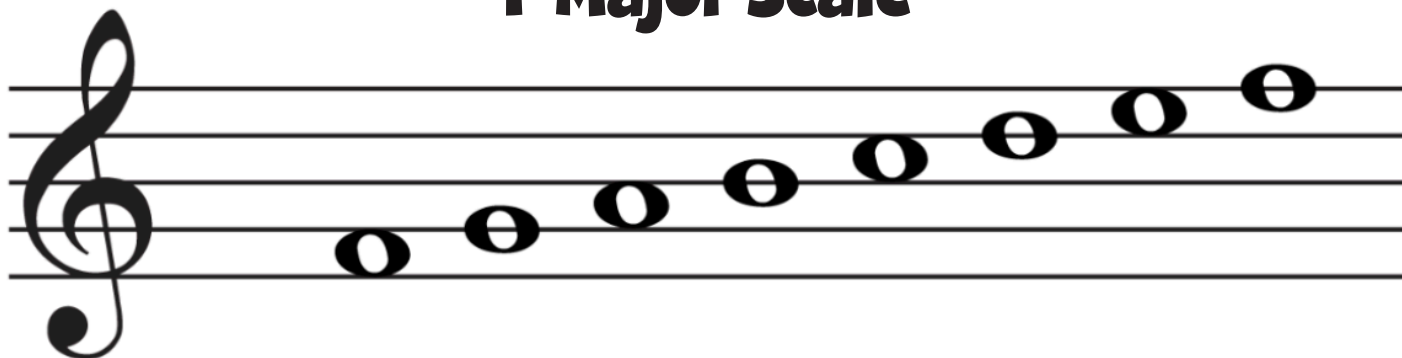
D.C. al Fine means to go back to the \_\_\_\_\_ and stop at the \_\_\_\_\_.

D.S. al Fine means to go back to the \_\_\_\_\_ and stop at the \_\_\_\_\_.

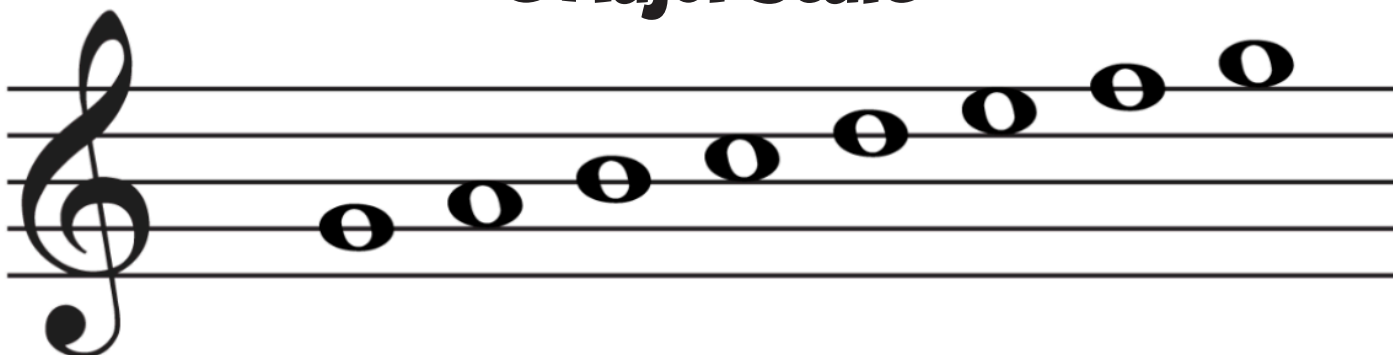
## Accidental Practice

Draw the correct accidental beside the correct note in each scale.

### F Major Scale



### G Major Scale



### What Are Accidentals?

Fill in the blanks to complete the definition.

Accidentals are \_\_\_\_\_, \_\_\_\_\_, or \_\_\_\_\_ used in a song that are not part of the original \_\_\_\_\_.



## Identify the Accidentals

Listen to "Perry the Sheep" and circle the accidentals in the vocal part.

Andante / With Humor 

accel.

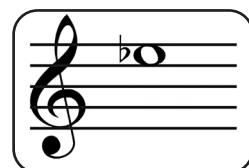


(recorder)



## Accidental Drill Down

Write the correct pitch name and accidental below each note.



Fill in each box with the correct dynamic symbol or word.

Listen to one of the tracks in Dynamic Choices, then mark the dynamics you hear in the score below.



*pp*

*p*

*mp*

$$mf$$
$$f$$
$$ff$$

# Notation Assessment

Choose the letter that best answers each question.

**1** The treble and bass clef staves combine to form \_\_\_\_\_.

**A.** the large staff

**B.** the grand staff

**C.** the song staff

**D.** the accidental staff

**2** What is "D.C. al Fine"?

**A.** It means to go back to the beginning and stop at the Fine.

**B.** It means to stop singing.

**C.** It means to go back to the sign and stop at the Fine.

**D.** It is not found in music.

**3** Where do you find the key signature?

**A.** At the end of the song

**B.** In the middle of the song

**C.** In every measure

**D.** At the beginning of the song

**4** Which word means very loud?

**A.** *Piano*

**B.** *Forte*

**C.** *Pianissimo*

**D.** *Fortissimo*

**5** Sharps, flats, and naturals are all examples of \_\_\_\_\_.

**A.** mistakes

**B.** accidentals

**C.** dynamics

**D.** repeat signs

## Literacy Connection

Read the story below and add dynamic markings wherever you think a change in volume would make it more fun. Then read the story out loud using the dynamics you added!

*pp**p**mp**mf**f**ff**pianissimo**piano**mezzo piano**mezzo forte**forte**fortissimo*

The Symphonic Sprouts Orchestra was deep into rehearsal when Maestro Pizzicato raised his baton and shouted, "Today, we play until perfection!"

"How long is that?" whispered Viola #2.

"Forever," groaned Oboe #1.

They played one song. Then they played another. Then they played ten more.

"Can we stop now?" asked Trumpet.

"Music never rests!" declared the Maestro, while accidentally conducting with his sandwich.

"I think he's losing it," said Clarinet, eyes wide.

Violin #3's bow got stuck in her hair. The bassoon started making whale sounds. The triangle player whispered, "Do I even play in this one?"

Just then, a tiny dog in a conductor's hat trotted onto the stage.

Everyone froze.

The dog gave a single "woof."

The musicians dropped their instruments. The Maestro paused, then said, "Fine. We'll stop... for now."

The triangle gave one final ding.

# Math Connection

Use the “Minka” score to answer the questions below.

## Minka

4    %

Mer - ry bells go ting - a - lin - gle; toes and fin - gers freeze and tin - gle.

9

With our friends we love to min - gle while the snow - flakes fall. **Fine**

13

Boys and girls are out to - geth - er clad in coats of fur and leath - er,

17

made to brave the cold - est weath - er when the sleigh bells ring. **D.S. al Fine**

1. How many measures are in the first section of “Minka” before the D.S. al Fine?

\_\_\_\_\_

2. How many measures are in the section after the D.S. al Fine (the repeated section)?

\_\_\_\_\_

3. What is the total number of measures in the song when you count both the first and repeated sections?

\_\_\_\_\_

# Reading Comprehension Skills

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## Reading the Dynamics

1. Imagine you are reading a story, but there are no clues about how the characters speak—no exclamation points, and no words like “whispered” or “shouted.” How would you know how to speak the words? In music, composers use dynamic markings to tell performers how softly or loudly to play. One of the most important types of notation that musicians read are dynamic markings because they guide performers in shaping the expressive intensity of the music, whether gentle or strong.
2. Instead of writing words like loud or soft over every note, musicians use specific symbols. If a composer wants a piece to be very soft and gentle, they write the symbol *pp*, which stands for *pianissimo*. In contrast, if the music should be very loud and powerful, they use *ff*, or *fortissimo*. These markings describe the character and energy of the sound to be performed.
3. Mastering these markings requires a musician to look ahead and prepare. Seeing a *pp* symbol tells the player to use less air or a lighter touch, while a *ff* symbol requires more energy. By using these graphic features, composers ensure that their musical message is performed with the right feeling every time.



### Did You Know?

The Italian word “piano” can mean “softly.”

This is why the original name of the instrument we call a piano is pianoforte—because it can play both soft and loud sounds!

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## Comprehension Questions

**1** What is the most likely reason the author included the “Did You Know?” sidebar at the end of the article?

|                                                                           |                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> To explain why the piano is the loudest instrument in the world | <b>B.</b> To provide interesting background information about the origin of a musical term |
| <b>C.</b> To identify the different parts of a piano’s keyboard           | <b>D.</b> To compare the history of Italian music to American music                        |

**2** Read the dictionary entry for the word “markings”.  
**markings** \ˈmär-kiŋz\ *noun*

|                                                             |                                                        |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1.</b> the natural patterns or colors on an animal’s fur | <b>2.</b> symbols or signs used to provide information |
| <b>3.</b> scratches left on a surface after a fall          | <b>4.</b> lines drawn on a map to show borders         |

Which definition most closely fits the way the word **markings** is used in paragraph 2?

|                        |                        |
|------------------------|------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Definition 1 | <b>B.</b> Definition 2 |
| <b>C.</b> Definition 3 | <b>D.</b> Definition 4 |

**3** Based on the article and the provided image, which TWO symbols would a musician use to change the volume of a song?

|                                             |                                     |
|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> <i>pp</i> ( <i>pianissimo</i> )   | <b>B.</b> <i>#</i> ( <i>sharp</i> ) |
| <b>C.</b> <i>ff</i> ( <i>fortissimo</i> )   | <b>D.</b> <i>b</i> ( <i>flat</i> )  |
| <b>E.</b> <i>&amp;</i> ( <i>ampersand</i> ) |                                     |

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

**4**

This item has two parts. Answer Part A, then answer Part B.

**Part A: What can the reader infer about a composer who uses many fortissimo markings in a song?**

- |                                                                                 |                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>A.</b> The composer wants the music to sound peaceful and sleepy.</p>     | <p><b>B.</b> The composer wants the music to be played with a lot of energy and strength.</p> |
| <p><b>C.</b> The composer is unsure about how the instruments should sound.</p> | <p><b>D.</b> The composer believes the musicians are not playing fast enough.</p>             |

**Part B: Which sentence from the passage best supports the answer to Part A?**

- |                                                                                                                |                                                                                                      |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>A.</b> "This is why the full name of the piano is pianoforte."</p>                                       | <p><b>B.</b> "The word piano in Italian actually means <i>soft</i>."</p>                             |
| <p><b>C.</b> "...if the music should be very loud and powerful, they use <i>ff</i>, or <i>fortissimo</i>."</p> | <p><b>D.</b> "Seeing a <i>pp</i> symbol tells the performer to use less air or a lighter touch."</p> |

**5**

**Explain how dynamic markings like *pianissimo* and *fortissimo* help a performer achieve the composer's purpose. Use details from the text to support your answer.**

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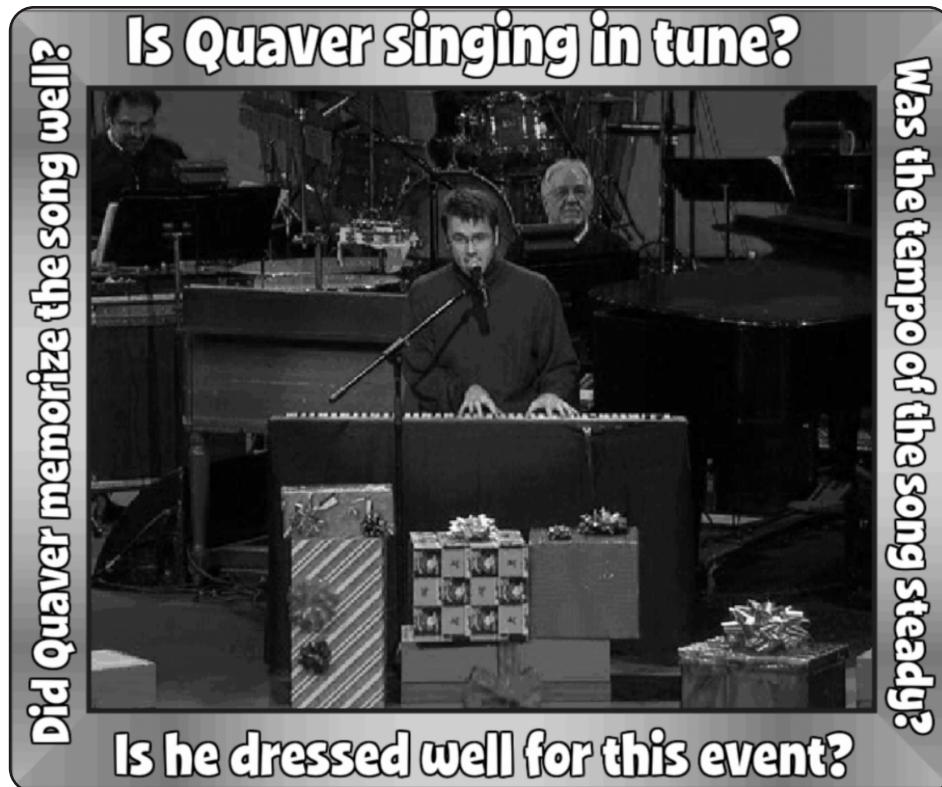
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# Evaluation Frames

As you listen to Quaver's performance of "Santa's Secret Helpers," use the evaluation frame to write an evaluation on the lines below.



\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

# Christmas Medley (3-5)

Create movements to “Christmas Medley,” then perform them while singing the song.

## DECK THE HALLS

Deck the halls with boughs of holly.

Fa la la la la, la la la la.

‘Tis the season to be jolly.

Fa la la la la, la la la la.

Don we now our gay apparel.

Fa la la la la, la la la la.

Troll the ancient yuletide carol.

Fa la la la la, la la la la.

## O CHRISTMAS TREE

O Christmas tree,

O Christmas tree,

how lovely are your branches.

O Christmas tree,

O Christmas tree,

how steadfast are your branches.

Your boughs are green in summer’s clime  
and through the snow of winter time.

O Christmas tree,

O Christmas tree,

how lovely are your branches.

## WE WISH YOU A MERRY CHRISTMAS

We wish you a Merry Christmas,

we wish you a Merry Christmas,

we wish you a Merry Christmas

and a Happy New Year!

**x2**

We wish you a Merry Christmas,

we wish you a Merry Christmas,

we wish you a Merry Christmas

and a Happy New Year!

# Dictation Is Everywhere!

Listen to each audio example and dictate the information you hear.

**What's the food order?**

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**What are the flight details?**

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---

---

**What jobs do I have to do?**

---

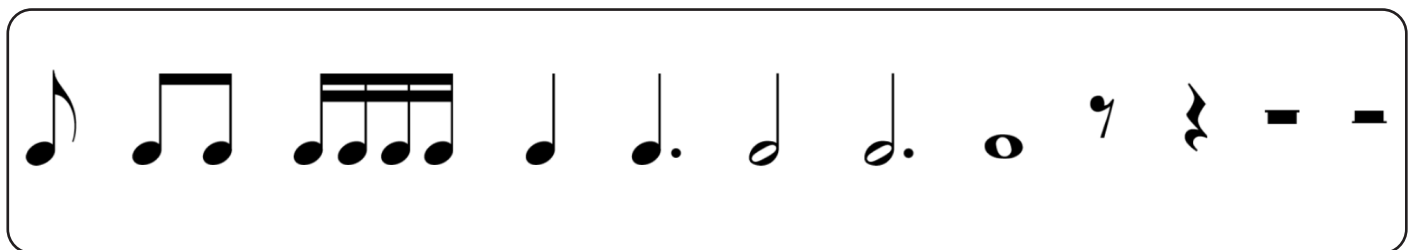
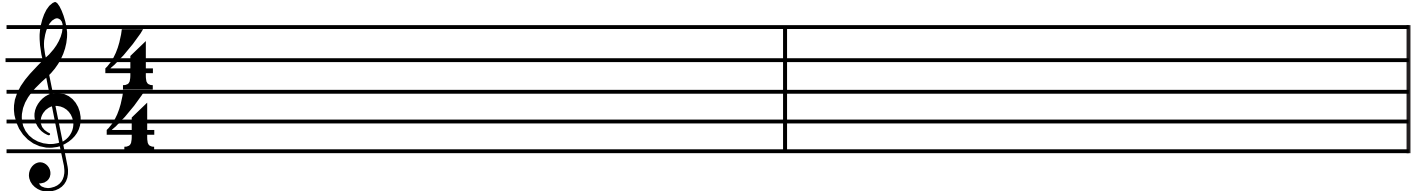
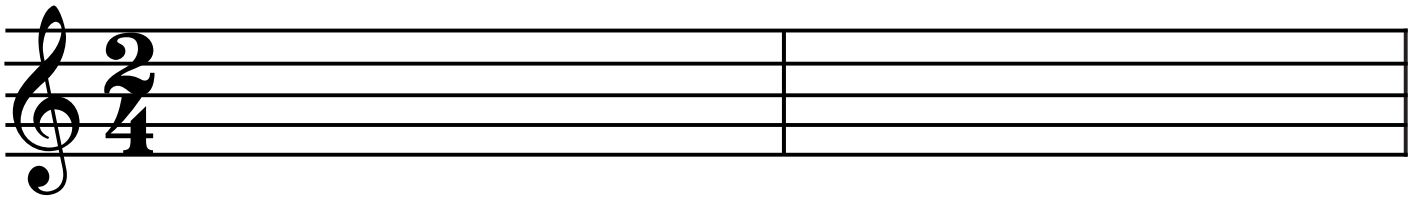
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# Rhythm Dictation

Use the staff, notes, and rests below to notate the rhythms the teacher plays.



## Essential Videos (Comparing Styles)

As you watch the videos, write about what makes each style unique in the boxes.

**Blues**

**Rock**

**Reggae**

**Country**

# Listening Assessment

Choose the letter that best answers each question.

## 1 Name this musical style.

*This question uses an audio example. The teacher will trigger the audio example from the screen.*

A. Blues

B. Reggae

C. Rock

D. Retro

## 2 Which combination of notes and rests equals a 4-beat measure?



## 3 To evaluate something means to \_\_\_\_\_.

A. invite special guests

B. cook a turkey in the oven

C. judge the quality

D. add up the total

## 4 This song is in a meter of \_\_\_\_\_.

*This question uses an audio example. The teacher will trigger the audio example from the screen.*

A. 5

B. 4

C. 8

D. 3

## 5 Which musical style uses a dobro?

A. Reggae

B. Country

C. Jazz

D. Rap

# Literacy Connection

Positive and constructive criticism should encourage people and help them know exactly what to work on. Rewrite each example of negative criticism into something positive and constructive.

## Examples:

| Negative Criticism              | Positive, Constructive Feedback Example                                                |
|---------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "You always mess up that part." | "That section is tough, but you're improving! Want to practice it together?"           |
| "That was really sloppy."       | "I like how you kept going! Try slowing it down a bit so it's easier to play cleanly." |

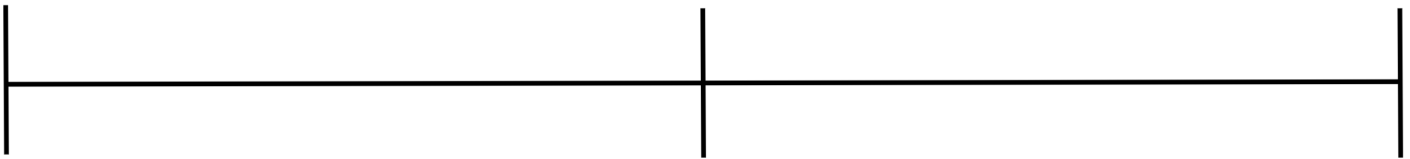
## Your Turn!

| Negative Criticism               | Make It Positive! <i>(Rewrite with kindness and helpful tips)</i> |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "You were way too loud."         |                                                                   |
| "That solo was boring."          |                                                                   |
| "You're always off beat."        |                                                                   |
| "You keep forgetting the notes." |                                                                   |
| "That performance was a mess."   |                                                                   |

## Math Connection

Create an 8-beat rhythm using quarter notes, eighth notes, and half notes. Then read your rhythm out loud to a partner while they write it down. Finally, compare to see if their version matches yours and check the math!

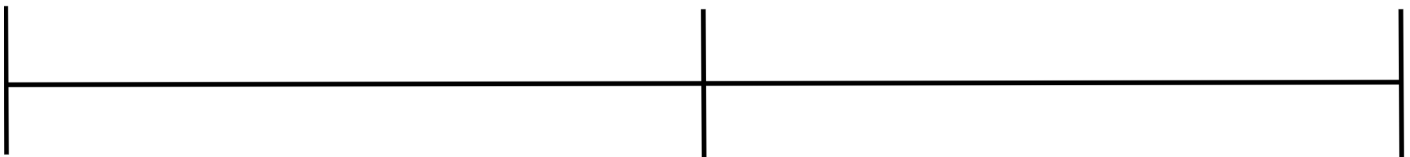
### My Rhythm:



How many sounds does your rhythm have? \_\_\_\_\_

My Partner's Name: \_\_\_\_\_

### My Partner's Rhythm:



How many sounds does your partner's rhythm have? \_\_\_\_\_

Did your partner write your rhythm down correctly? \_\_\_\_\_

Did you write your partner's rhythm down correctly? \_\_\_\_\_



# Reading Comprehension Skills

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## The Art of Active Listening

1. People often treat music like background noise while they do homework or clean their rooms. However, I believe that to truly appreciate music, one must practice active listening. Active listening is not just hearing a sound; it is a process of focusing intently on specific sounds. Active listeners analyze the elements of music and instruments used, leading to a deeper understanding of the intention behind the music.
2. When you listen actively, you can identify specific musical styles. For example, if you hear a solo trumpet playing syncopated rhythms over a walking bass line, you can conclude the style is likely jazz. Without focus, the unique rhythm of that genre would just blend into the mix. By paying attention, you become a musical detective who can solve the mystery of how a song was built.
3. Furthermore, active listening allows you to hear the harmony—the way different notes and chords blend together to create a feeling. A song might feel heavy or bright based on these layers of changing chords. If we only listen halfway, we might miss the emotional depth that the artist created through their harmonic choices. We should all put away our distractions and give music our full attention.

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## Comprehension Questions

**1** What is the author's primary argument in this passage?

- |                                                                                                 |                                                                                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>A.</b> Jazz is the only musical style that is worth listening to.</p>                     | <p><b>B.</b> Musicians should only play solo instruments like the trumpet.</p>           |
| <p><b>C.</b> People should focus completely on music to truly understand and appreciate it.</p> | <p><b>D.</b> Background noise is helpful for students who are trying to do homework.</p> |

**2** Which of the following is the BEST way to combine the ideas in these two sentences from paragraph 1?

*Active listening is not just hearing a sound. It is a process of focusing intently on specific sounds.*

- |                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>A.</b> Active listening is not just hearing a sound, or it is a process of focusing on specific sounds.</p>   | <p><b>B.</b> Because active listening is not just hearing a sound, it is a process of focusing on specific sounds.</p> |
| <p><b>C.</b> Active listening is not just hearing a sound, but rather a process of focusing on specific sounds.</p> | <p><b>D.</b> Active listening is not just hearing a sound, and focusing on specific sounds is also a process.</p>      |

**3** Based on paragraph 2, the reader can conclude that active listening is a skill that helps a person \_\_\_\_.

- |                                                                  |                                                                                 |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>A.</b> play the trumpet better than their classmates</p>   | <p><b>B.</b> recognize different musical styles by hearing specific details</p> |
| <p><b>C.</b> write their own songs using a walking bass line</p> | <p><b>D.</b> finish their homework much faster than usual</p>                   |

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

**4**

*This item has two parts. Answer Part A, then answer Part B.*

**Part A: According to the author, how does harmony affect a listener's experience?**

- |                                                                                        |                                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>A.</b> It provides a syncopated rhythm that tells a story.</p>                   | <p><b>B.</b> It changes the mood of the song to feel heavy or bright.</p> |
| <p><b>C.</b> It acts as background noise so the listener can focus on other tasks.</p> | <p><b>D.</b> It prevents the melody from being heard clearly.</p>         |

**Part B: Explain how the mood of a song might change when the harmony changes. Use at least two content-area vocabulary words in your response.**

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**5**

**Based on the author's message, explain why active listening is more valuable than hearing music as background noise. In your answer, use at least three vocabulary words such as *instruments, mood, melody, rhythm, or harmony*, and include a transition word like *because* or *for example* to connect your ideas.**

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## Give It Up! for the Brass Family

Listen to each piece, then describe their differences and the feelings the music evokes.

### Piece 1

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### Piece 2

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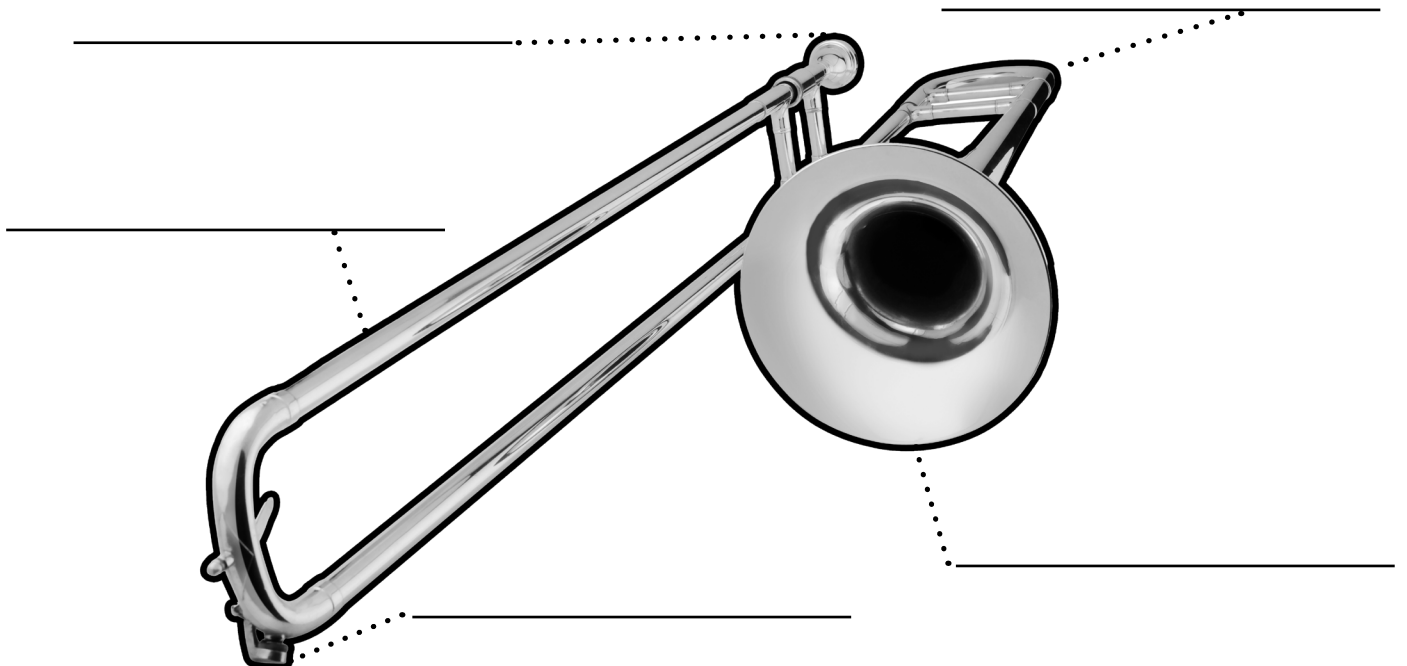
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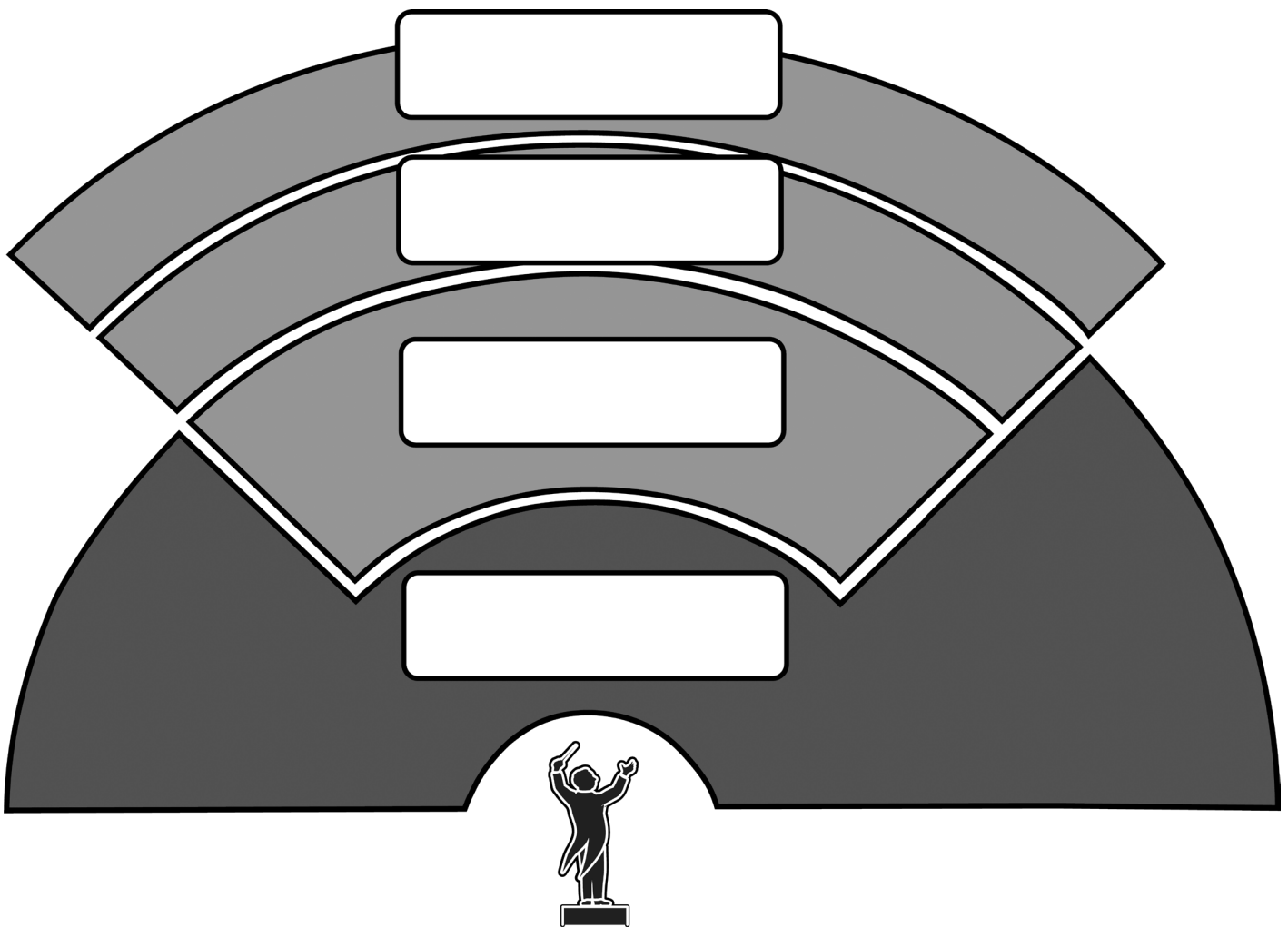
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Fill in the blanks with the correct name for each part of the trombone.



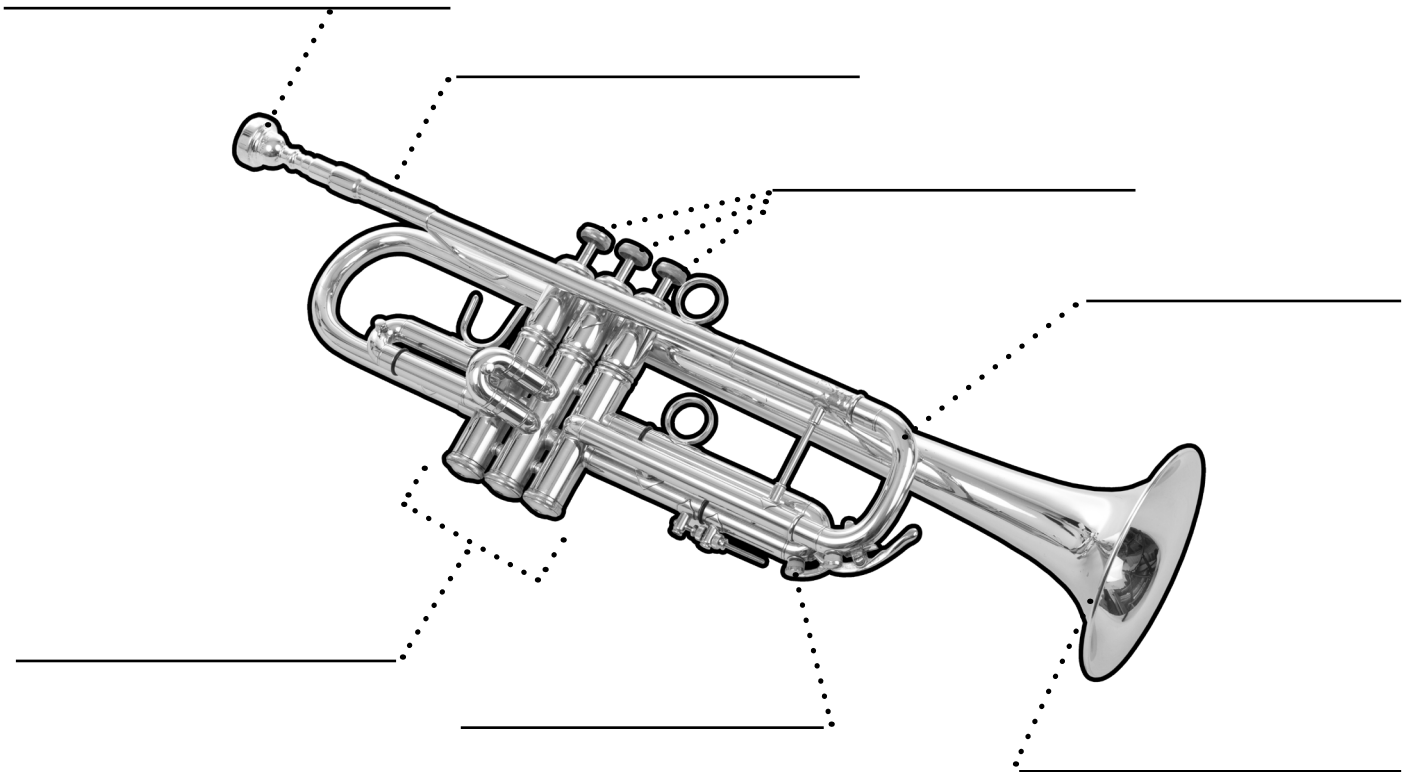
# The Orchestra

Label the sections of the orchestra with the correct instrument family.



# Brass Instrument Detectives

Identify the brass instrument below and label each of its parts.



Describe the instrument's range, timbre, and playing technique after watching the *Timbre* and *Playing Techniques* videos in this lesson.

**Name of instrument:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Range:** \_\_\_\_\_

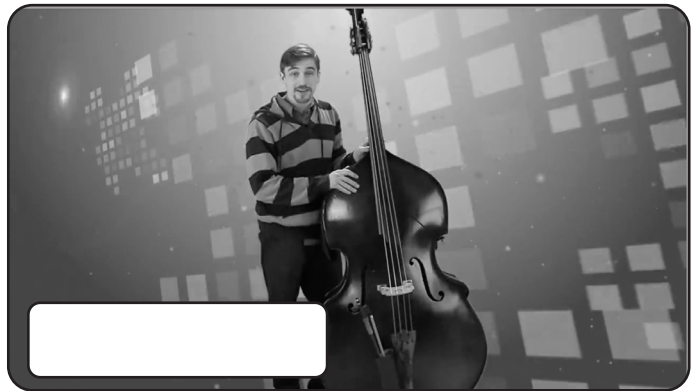
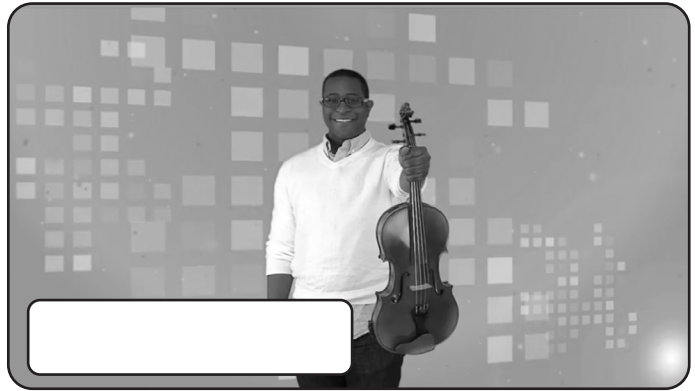
**Timbre:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Playing technique:** \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_

# The Four Strings

Identify each instrument by writing its name in the box with the corresponding picture.





## Stringy Facts

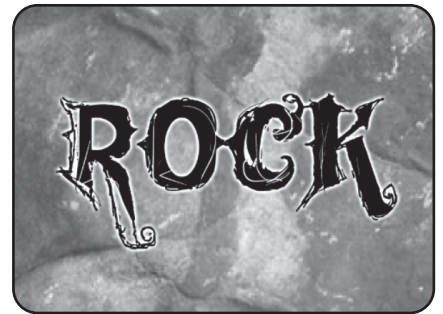
Fill in the facts about the violin.

1. Strings used to be made of \_\_\_\_\_ gut. Now most strings are made of \_\_\_\_\_ .
2. The modern violin is made of either \_\_\_\_\_ or \_\_\_\_\_ wood. There are \_\_\_\_\_ individual pieces of wood that make up the violin's body.
3. Over the centuries, different-sized \_\_\_\_\_ were developed. The one you play is based on your \_\_\_\_\_. There are now \_\_\_\_\_ different sizes of violin. The smallest violin was measured at \_\_\_\_\_ cm long.
4. The inventor of the violin was named Andrea \_\_\_\_\_ .
5. The violin's bow is made from \_\_\_\_\_ hair.
6. The most famous violin maker was called \_\_\_\_\_. One of his violins made in 1697 sold for \$ \_\_\_\_\_ million.



# Strings Are Everywhere!

Listen to each style. Choose your favorite, then describe what you like about it and how the strings sound.



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# All About Strings and Music Styles

Respond to the prompts about strings and music styles below.

**In addition to classical, name two music styles that use string instruments.**

1. \_\_\_\_\_
2. \_\_\_\_\_

**Describe how strings are used in one of the above styles (such as a fiddle being used for harmony and soloing in country music).**

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# Instruments Assessment

Choose the letter that best answers each question.

**1** **Pizzicato means to \_\_\_\_\_ .**

**A.** use short, rapid back-and-forth strokes over the strings

**B.** play lightly with the bow

**C.** pluck the strings

**D.** pick up a pizza

**2** **While pressing a string on the fingerboard, the finger moves rapidly from side to side to create a varying pitch. This describes \_\_\_\_\_ .**

**A.** arco

**B.** vibrato

**C.** calypso

**D.** bel canto

**3** **The faster you buzz your lips when playing a brass instrument, the \_\_\_\_\_ the sound.**

**A.** lower

**B.** longer

**C.** slower

**D.** higher

**4** **Which of the words below means to “play with a bow”?**

**A.** Arco

**B.** Vibrato

**C.** Marco

**D.** Tremolo

**5** **What are the four main instruments of the string family?**

**A.** Violin, viola, guitar, banjo

**B.** Harp, cello, steel guitar, bass fiddle

**C.** Guitar, banjo, mandolin, dobro

**D.** Violin, viola, cello, double bass

# Literacy Connection

Pick your favorite orchestra instrument and pretend it's the main character in a story you imagine! Will it go on an adventure, join a band, or try something new?

## Step 1: Choose Your Instrument

\_\_\_\_\_

## Step 2: Write Your Mini-Story (five–seven sentences)

*Make sure your instrument has a name, a goal, and something exciting or funny that happens!*

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

## Bonus: Draw a picture of your instrument in the box below.

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

# Math Connection

Use your imagination and math skills to plan out the formation, group size, and steps for your own square dance!

## Step 1: Dance Formation

### What will the formation look like?

#### How many people will be in your square dance?

*(Remember: A traditional square dance has four sets of partners, but you can be creative!)*

My dance will have \_\_\_\_\_ people.

#### Will they form a square, circle, or line?

*(Circle, square, or a new shape you invent!)*

My formation will be: \_\_\_\_\_ .

## Step 2: Partners or Whole Group?

### Will your square dance be for partners or a whole group?

I want my dance to be: \_\_\_\_\_ .

## Step 3: Dance Steps and Patterns

### What will the dancers do?

#### Think of a few steps or movements to make your square dance fun.

Step 1: \_\_\_\_\_ . *(Example: "Step forward and clap.")*

Step 2: \_\_\_\_\_ . *(Example: "Turn around and bow.")*

Step 3: \_\_\_\_\_ . *(Example: "Slide to the right and tap your feet.")*

## 🔍 Bonus: What do you think would be the most fun part of your square dance?

# Reading Comprehension Skills

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## The Fiddle Challenge

1. Clara stared at her violin sitting in its velvet-lined case. For three years, she had played nothing but Classical pieces. She loved the elegant, smooth sounds of the orchestra, but lately, she felt a pull toward something different. In the hallway, she heard the rhythmic stomp-clap of the school's talent show rehearsals.
2. Her friend Sam was practicing a bluegrass song on his banjo. "Hey Clara! Give us some fiddle!" he shouted. Clara hesitated. In her lessons, she was taught to play with a long, flowing bow. But bluegrass and country music used the violin differently—they called it a fiddle. In addition to smooth melodies, the fiddle provided a percussive, choppy sound for harmony and dance-like solos
3. Clara stepped into the circle. She took a deep breath and began to play. At first, her playing was too stiff, but then she watched Sam's foot tapping the beat. She loosened her wrist and played a shuffle rhythm. She added chops and double stops, and her sound was bright and gritty. By the time they reached the final chorus, Clara wasn't just playing a violin; she was leading a hoedown! She realized that the same four strings could play in two completely different styles depending on her technique.



## The Versatile String Family

While the violin is famous in Classical music, it adds lots to other genres too!

**Country/Bluegrass:** Known as the fiddle, it plays fast solos and rhythmic accompaniments.

**Jazz:** Violinists often use syncopation to play unexpected, improvised melodies.

**Rock:** Some bands use electric violins to add a lush layer to loud songs.

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## Comprehension Questions

**1** What is the most likely reason the author included the “The Versatile String Family” inset at the end of the story?

- |                                                                             |                                                                                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> To explain why Clara decided to quit playing Classical music      | <b>B.</b> To provide extra information about how the violin is used in different musical styles |
| <b>C.</b> To identify the specific wood used to build a professional fiddle | <b>D.</b> To compare the cost of a violin to the cost of a banjo                                |

**2** Read the dictionary entry for the word shuffle.

**shuffle** \ˈshə-fəl verb

- |                                                                 |                                                                       |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1.</b> to walk without lifting the feet fully off the ground | <b>2.</b> to mix a deck of playing cards                              |
| <b>3.</b> to move items around into a different order           | <b>4.</b> a specific rhythmic pattern used in country and blues music |

Which definition most closely fits the way the word shuffle is used in paragraph 3?

- |                        |                        |
|------------------------|------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Definition 1 | <b>B.</b> Definition 2 |
| <b>C.</b> Definition 3 | <b>D.</b> Definition 4 |

**3** Based on the story, which TWO details support the idea that the violin is a versatile instrument?

- |                                                           |                                                                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Clara has played the violin for three years.    | <b>B.</b> The violin is called a fiddle when used in country music.      |
| <b>C.</b> Sam plays the banjo in a talent show rehearsal. | <b>D.</b> Violins can be used to play improvised melodies in jazz music. |
| <b>E.</b> Clara’s violin case is lined with soft velvet.  |                                                                          |

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

**4**

*This item has two parts. Answer Part A, then answer Part B.*

**Part A: What is a key difference between Classical violin and country fiddle as described in the text?**

- |                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Classical music uses four strings, but the fiddle uses only two.                                              | <b>B.</b> Classical music is always loud, while Country music is always soft.                      |
| <b>C.</b> Classical music focuses on smooth melodies, while the fiddle uses percussive "chops" for a more gritty sound. | <b>D.</b> Classical music is played for harmony, but the fiddle is only used for background noise. |

**Part B: Which sentence from the story best supports the answer to Part A?**

- |                                                                                                           |                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> "In addition to smooth melodies, the fiddle provided a percussive, choppy sound for harmony..." | <b>B.</b> "Sam was practicing a Bluegrass song on his banjo."                                        |
| <b>C.</b> "Clara stared at her violin sitting in its velvet-lined case."                                  | <b>D.</b> "She realized that the same four strings could play in two completely different styles..." |

**5**

**Retell how Clara's playing style changed. Explain what she did differently to play in a Bluegrass style compared to her Classical lessons. Be sure to use transition words like *first*, *then*, and *finally* to organize your response.**

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**Impressionist**  
1870 - 1910

# Classical Connections Journal Page

## 2nd Movement, Pour le Piano by Debussy



Debussy is one of the most popular composers of the Impressionist Period.

**What characteristics of Impressionist Period music do you hear in this piece?**

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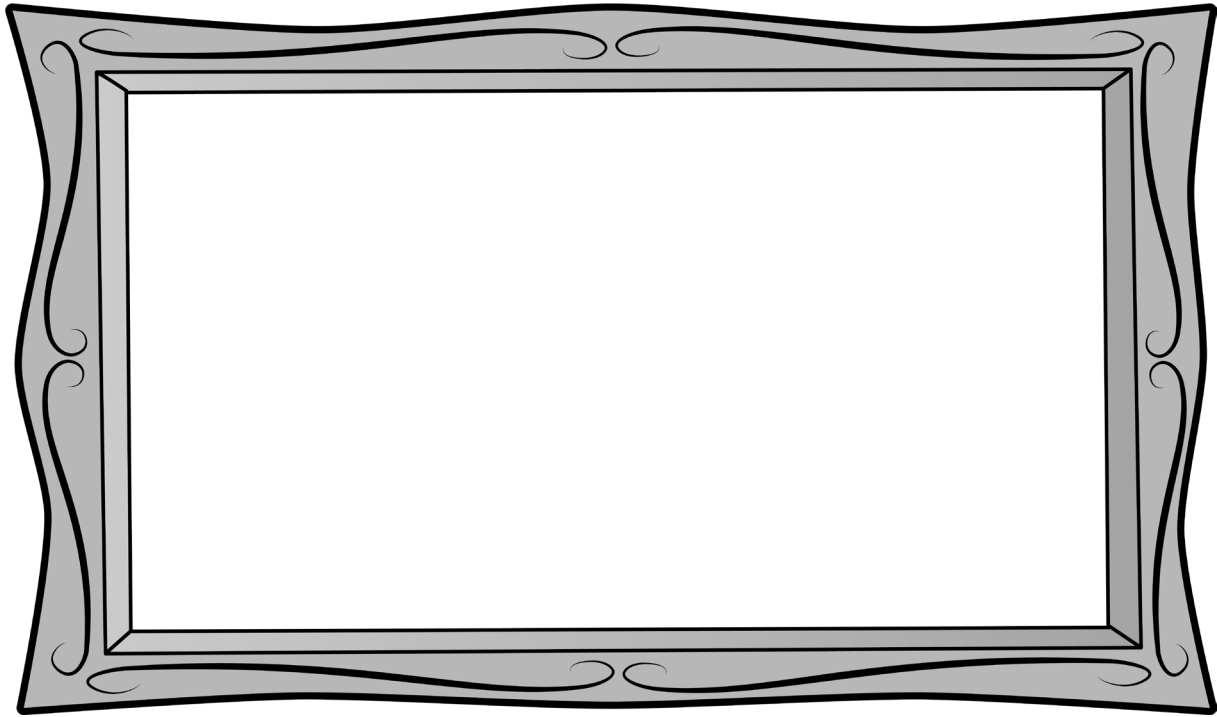
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**Song Rating:** ☆☆☆☆☆

**Why?** \_\_\_\_\_

## Debussy's Art Gallery

Listen to Debussy's piece in the Art Gallery screen and draw art inspired by the music.



## Brushing Up on the Impressionist Period

Use the word bank to complete the statements.

1. During the Impressionist Period, music was used to create \_\_\_\_\_ in the mind.
2. Impressionist music is intended to create subtle \_\_\_\_\_, sounds, \_\_\_\_\_ and dream-like \_\_\_\_\_.

### Word Bank

**feelings**

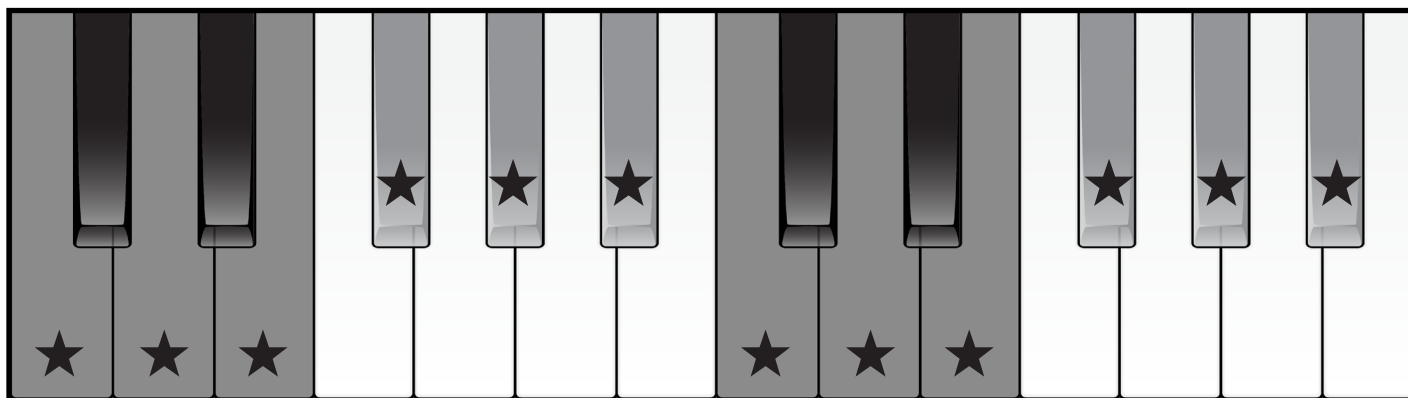
**pictures**

**impressions**

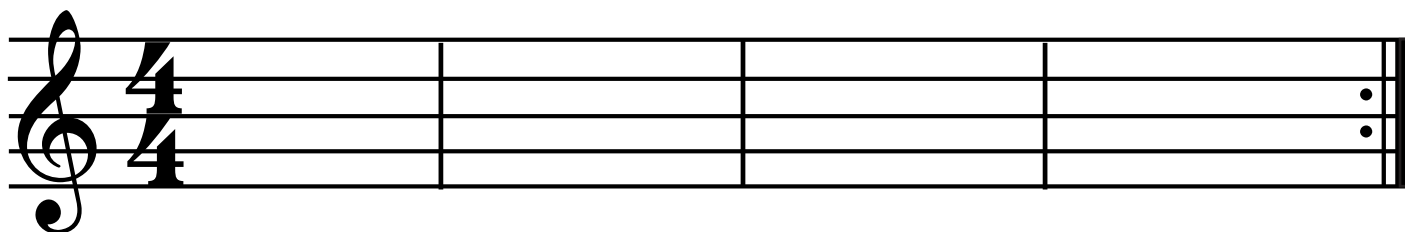
**moods**

# My Whole Tone Composition

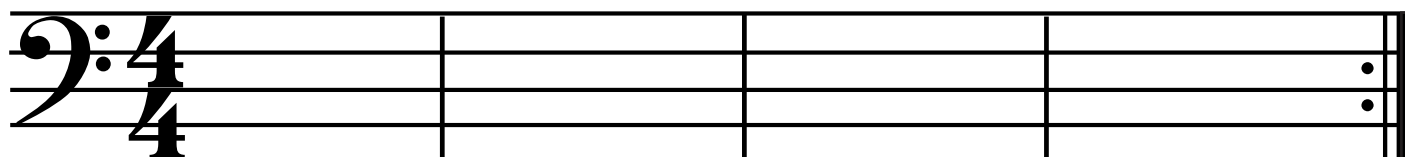
Use only the highlighted keys to create a whole tone melody and chord accompaniment.



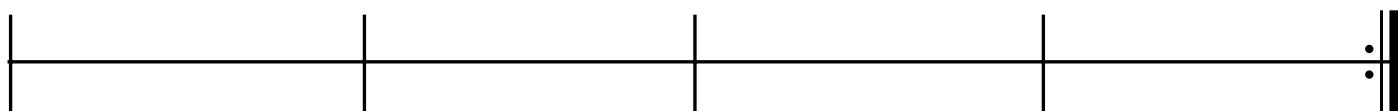
## My Melody



## My Accompaniment Chords



## My Rhythm



# Famous Impressionist Composers

Draw a line to match each fact with the correct composer.



Wrote *Clair de Lune*

Wrote *La Mer*

Audience both cheered and booed after he performed one of his compositions

Most famous for his composition *Bolero*, which he considered trivial

His teachers weren't happy with his experimentation in chords, sounds, and timbres

# Impressionist Period Assessment

Choose the letter that best answers each question.

## 1 When was the Impressionist Period?

**A.** 450 B.C. — Present

**B.** 1800 — 1960

**C.** 2001 — 2012

**D.** 1870 — 1910

## 2 Who are the two most famous Impressionist composers?

**A.** Williams and Zimmer

**B.** Mozart and Beethoven

**C.** Bach and Handel

**D.** Debussy and Ravel

## 3 What type of music is this?

*This question uses an audio example. The teacher will trigger the audio example from the screen.*

**A.** Impressionist

**B.** Ragtime

**C.** Rock

**D.** Rap

## 4 What type of scale was popular in Impressionist music?

**A.** Diatonic scale

**B.** Whole tone scale

**C.** Melodic minor scale

**D.** Digital scale

## 5 Impressionist music is intended to \_\_\_\_\_.

**A.** create subtle pictures, sounds, moods, and dream-like feelings

**B.** create loud, distorted sounds

**C.** create sharp, well-defined musical contrasts

**D.** create only keyboard sounds

## Literacy Connection

Think about the dreamy, mysterious, and emotional sounds of Impressionist music, then fill in the blanks and complete the story with your own adjectives, nouns, and verbs. Once you've finished the story, read it out loud and see how it captures the mood of Impressionist music.

As the \_\_\_\_\_ sky began to fade into twilight, I sat by  
(adjective)

the \_\_\_\_\_ and listened to the \_\_\_\_\_ sounds  
(noun) (adjective)

of the orchestra. The \_\_\_\_\_ played a melody that  
(instrument)

reminded me of \_\_\_\_\_. I closed my eyes and began  
(something in nature)

to \_\_\_\_\_ as the notes floated through the air like  
(verb)

\_\_\_\_\_. Everything felt \_\_\_\_\_ and \_\_\_\_\_,  
(plural noun) (emotion) (adjective)

like I had stepped into a painting made of \_\_\_\_\_.  
(plural noun)

The music whispered secrets only the \_\_\_\_\_ could  
(animal)

understand, and I didn't want it to end.

# Math Connection

In your group, you will create and perform a 30-second sonic postcard to describe a special place. Use instruments, body percussion, and vocal effects instead of words to communicate the essence of any special place you can imagine.

**Choose a place:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Make a Graphic Score:**

*Create a graphic score with shapes, lines, and colors to represent your sounds.*

**Rehearse:** Practice your performance without letting other groups overhear.

**Perform and Guess:** Perform your sonic postcard. The other groups will listen and try to guess where you've been.

**How many total sections** did you include in your sonic postcard? \_\_\_\_\_

**List each section** of your piece and estimate how many seconds long it was.

**Write each section's duration as a fraction** of the whole 30 seconds.

*(Example: If one section is 10 seconds, it's 10/30 or 1/3 of the piece.)*

**Did any sections have the same duration?** If so, which ones? What fraction of the piece do they each represent? \_\_\_\_\_

**What was the shortest section?** What fraction of the whole piece is that? \_\_\_\_\_

**What was the longest section?** What fraction of the piece is that? \_\_\_\_\_

Do all your section fractions add up to 1 (or 30/30)? Check your math and explain if they don't.

# Reading Comprehension Skills

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## A Night in the Garden

1. The year was 1930, and Paris was the brightest jewel in Europe. In a quiet garden, a young pianist named Marc sit near a pond. He had lived during the Impressionist Period, a time when artists cared more about the feeling of a moment than about strict rules. Marc saw the moon's reflection and thought about the music of Claude Debussy.
2. Earlier that day, he heard a performance of Debussy's "Clair de Lune." The title translated to "by the moonlight," and Marc could imagine the glowing streaks of moonlight hitting the pavement. Unlike the structured music of the past, this music felt like a dream. Marc began to hum, realizing the composer chose soft musical colors to match the French night.
3. Suddenly, the mood shifted. From a nearby house, the pulse of Maurice Ravel's "Boléro" rose. This Spanish dance in triple meter grew louder and stronger. Marc stood, caught between Debussy's peaceful moonbeams and Ravel's driving energy. Impressionist musicians took risks to capture the spirit of their surroundings. Marc knew he was living in an exciting time for art.



# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## Comprehension Questions

**1** How does the historical setting of the Impressionist Period influence the plot?

- |                                                               |                                                                                                    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> It forces Marc to leave Paris to find a new piano.  | <b>B.</b> It provides the artistic atmosphere that helps Marc understand the feeling of the music. |
| <b>C.</b> It creates a conflict where Marc must stop humming. | <b>D.</b> It prevents Marc from hearing any music other than traditional marches.                  |

**2** There is an error in paragraph 1: “Marc sit near a pond.” What is the correct way to write the irregular past-tense of the verb sit?

- |                   |                |
|-------------------|----------------|
| <b>A.</b> Sitted  | <b>B.</b> Sat  |
| <b>C.</b> Sitting | <b>D.</b> Sate |

**3** Marc wants to compare the songs he heard and his surroundings. Which sentence uses a comparative or superlative adjective correctly?

- |                                                                      |                                                                      |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Debussy’s song was the peacefulest one in the garden.      | <b>B.</b> Ravel’s music sounded strongerer than the quiet night.     |
| <b>C.</b> Marc thought the moon was the brightest object in the sky. | <b>D.</b> Paris was a more better place for art than any other city. |

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

**4**

*This item has two parts. Answer Part A, then answer Part B.*

**Part A: What is a key difference between the two musical works mentioned in the story?**

- |                                                                                     |                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> Debussy's music is loud, while Ravel's music is silent.                   | <b>B.</b> "Clair de Lune" is dreamy and soft, while "Boléro" is a rhythmic Spanish dance. |
| <b>C.</b> One is played only in the morning, and the other is played only at night. | <b>D.</b> Ravel's music is about the moon, while Debussy's is a fast dance.               |

**Part B: Which sentence from the story best supports the answer to Part A?**

- |                                                                                                 |                                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> "Marc sit near a pond."                                                               | <b>B.</b> "Marc began to hum the melody."                                                  |
| <b>C.</b> "Marc stood, caught between Debussy's peaceful moonbeams and Ravel's driving energy." | <b>D.</b> "In this era, musicians took risks to capture the spirit of their surroundings." |

**5**

**Explain how the setting of the garden at night influenced Marc's understanding of the music. Use at least one irregular past-tense verb, such as *felt* or *thought*, and the possessive case, such as *Ravel's* or *Marc's*, in your response.**

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**Romantic**

1820 - 1910

# Classical Connections Journal Page

"Grand March" from *Aida* and  
4th Movement, Symphony No. 9 (*New World Symphony*)  
by Verdi and Dvořák



**Listen to both pieces of music. Write whether you think each is in a major key or minor key, and why.**

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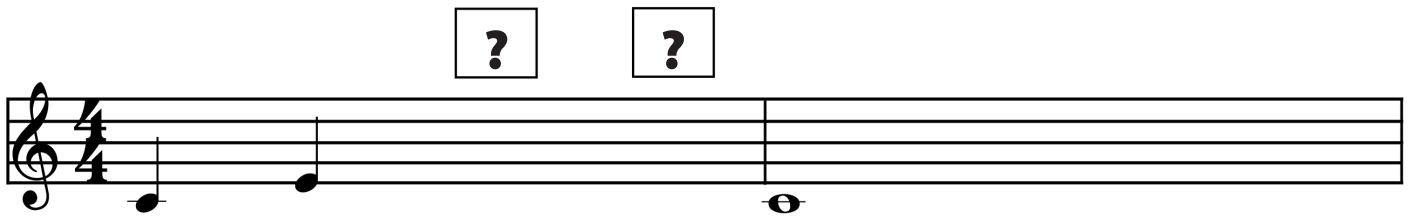
**Song Rating:** ☆☆☆☆☆

**Why?** \_\_\_\_\_

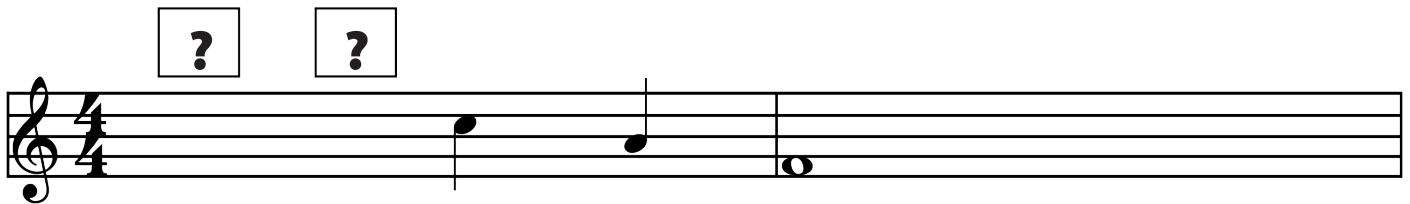
# Arpeggios and Block Chords

Write the missing pitches on the staff to create an arpeggio for each chord.

## C Major

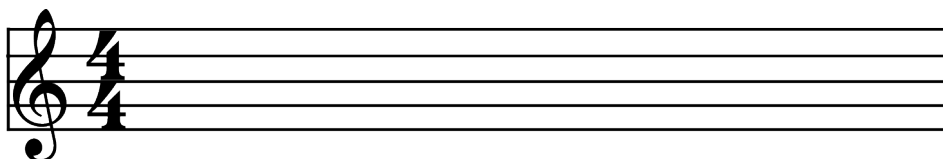


## F Major



Write a block chord for the G major arpeggio below on the blank staff.

## G Major



# Chords and Country Music Review

Choose the best word to fill in the blanks.

## Word Bank

**yodeling**

**accompaniment**

**country**

**arpeggio**

**fiddle**

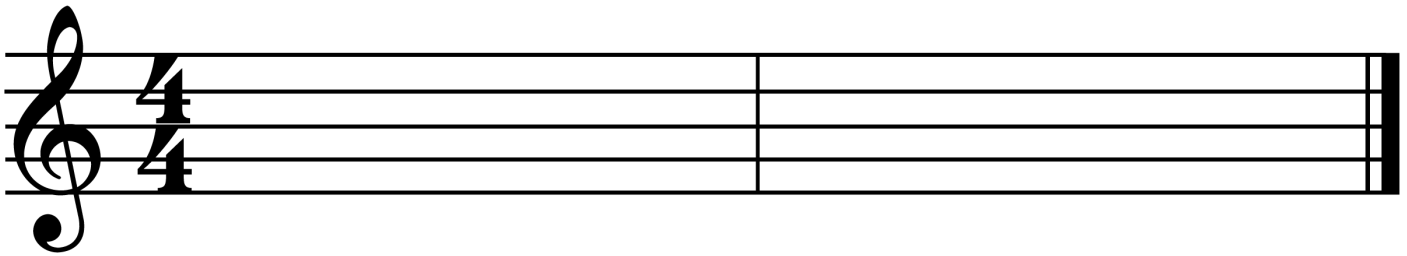
1. "Simple stories in simple ways" best describes \_\_\_\_\_ music.
2. Pitches of a chord played one after another are called a(n) \_\_\_\_\_ .
3. \_\_\_\_\_ is a unique style of singing associated with country music.
4. The dobro, banjo, mandolin, \_\_\_\_\_, and acoustic bass are instruments often used in country music.
5. Chords and harmony provide the \_\_\_\_\_ for melodies.

# Writing Major and Minor Chords

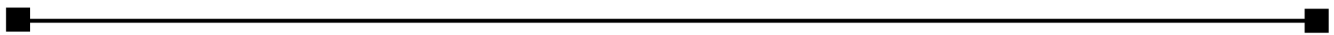
Write the correct chord in each measure using whole notes. Use the scales below each example to guide you. Don't forget to lower the third note in the scale a half step when writing minor chords.

## C Major Chord

## C minor Chord

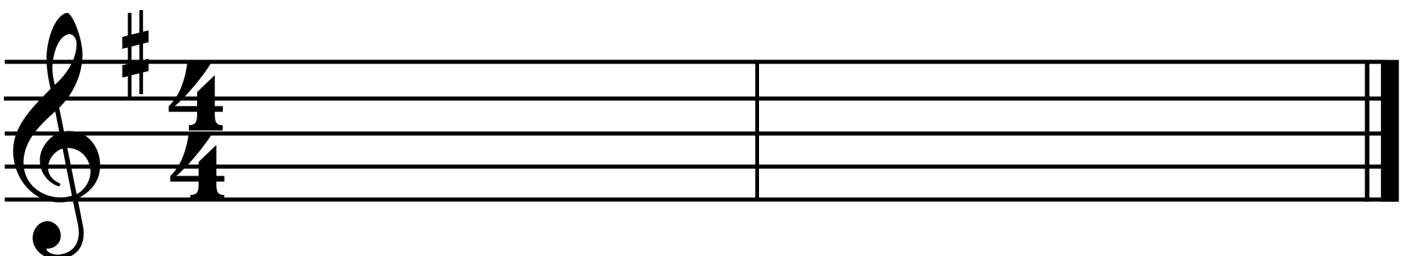


**C D E F G A B C**



## G Major Chord

## G minor Chord



**G A B C D E F# G**



## F Major Chord

## F minor Chord



**F G A Bb C D E F**

# I Wanna Go to the Country

## Chord Chart

Listen to "I Wanna Go to the Country" and fill in the chord chart with **C/I**, **F/IV**, or **G/V**.

5 **C/I**

I wan - na go to the coun - try to see all there is to see. The  
 I wan - na go to the coun - try and do all there is to do,

7 **G/V**

cit - y's nice, but I'd like to get a - way.  
 ride a horse down a trail on a sun - ny day.

9

I wan - na wear a cow - boy hat crow and put on my old blue jeans through and  
 I wan - na hear a roost - er crow when the sun breaks through and

11 **F/IV**

sit down by the fire on a bale of hay. 'Cause there's  
 stare out at the stars when the day - light fades.

13 **G/V**

some - thing a - bout the way a cool breeze sounds, and there's

15 **F/IV** **G/V**

noth - ing else a - round to drown it out. I wan - na go.

18 **C/I** 1.

Oh, I wan - na go.

# All About Chords

Fill in the blanks to complete the statements.

1. A diagram that shows only chords and lyrics is called a \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_.
2. Chord symbols can also be displayed as \_\_\_\_\_ depending on where they appear in a scale.
3. The \_\_\_\_\_ note in a chord determines whether the chord is major or minor.
4. Write two to four adjectives that describe the sound of a major chord:  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_
5. Write two to four adjectives that describe the sound of a minor chord:  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_



# Ti Fi Anro

## Chord Chart

Listen to "Ti Fi Anro." Write the chord symbols in the boxes using **C/I**, **F/IV**, and **G/V**.

**Ti fi anro ban'm nouvel o**

**Sak pase la kay la tande**

**Ti fi anro ban'm nouvel o**

**Sak pase la kay la tande**

**O ki koze'm sa ki travay mwen sa**

**Mwen soti nan mòn mal keyi kafe**

**Wòch woule nan pye'm tande tande**

**Mwen soti nan mòn mal keyi kafe**

**Wòch woule nan pye'm tande**

# Chords and Harmony Assessment

Choose the letter that best answers each question.

**1** Another word for a “broken chord” is \_\_\_\_\_.

A. cheerio

B. major

C. arpeggio

D. progression

**2** A studio musician would most likely be reading a(n) \_\_\_\_\_.

A. chord poster

B. chord chart

C. arpeggio

D. chord book

**3** A \_\_\_\_\_ is moving from one chord to another in a song.

A. chord progression

B. confession

C. aggression

D. obsession

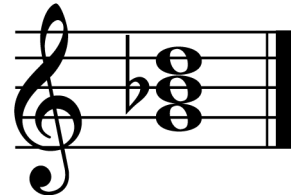
**4** Look at the picture. What is the name of the chord?

A. C Major

B. B-flat Major

C. C minor

D. G minor



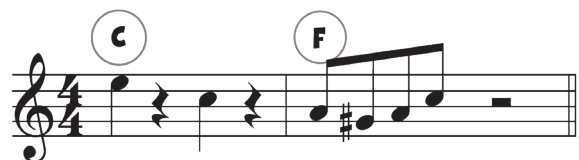
**5** What is circled in this picture?

A. Chord tractors

B. Chord numbers

C. Chord symbols

D. Chord diagrams



## Literacy Connection

In the first column on the chart below, write what you already know about country music. In the second column, write at least two things you want to know about. After exploring more about country music, fill in the last column with what you learned.

| K - What I Know | W - What I Want to Know | L - What I Learned |
|-----------------|-------------------------|--------------------|
|                 |                         |                    |

**Name:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Math Connection

While listening to “Professor McDuffin,” follow along with the chord changes on the board. Each time you see a major or minor chord, put a tally in the Major Chords or Minor Chords column. Next, count the tallies and fill in the total for each type of chord. Then answer the questions at the bottom.

| Major Chords         | Minor Chords         |
|----------------------|----------------------|
| <p><b>Total:</b></p> | <p><b>Total:</b></p> |

### Which type of chord did you hear more often in this song?

**How did the major chords make the music feel?** (Circle one or describe in your own words.)

Happy      Neutral      Sad      Dramatic      Other: \_\_\_\_\_

### Did the mix of major and minor chords change the mood throughout the song?

**If so, how?** (Circle one or describe in your own words.)

Happy      Neutral      Sad      Dramatic      Other: \_\_\_\_\_

### Did the mix of major and minor chords change the mood throughout the song?

## If so, how?

# Reading Comprehension Skills

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## The Three-Chord Truth

1. If you turn on a radio and hear the twang of a steel guitar, you have likely found a country music station. While this style is famous for its storytelling, its secret weapon is actually harmony. Most country songs are built simple chord progressions, which are a series of musical chords played in a set order.
2. One common pattern in this genre is the I-IV-V-I progression. These Roman numerals represent chords built on the first (I), fourth (IV), and fifth (V) pitches of a scale. Musicians use these three chords to create a home-away-home feeling. For example, the I chord feels like home, the IV and V chords create tension, and the final I chord brings the song back to a restful end. This simple structure allows even a new listener to predict where the music is going.
3. In music class, students may create their own country-inspired accompaniments to go along with a singer. They might use a guitar or a piano to play these three chords. By recognizing this progression, a student can play along with almost any country song, even if they have never heard it before, by predicting what chord will come next. Whether it is a slow ballad or a fast dance, the harmony remains the reliable foundation of the track.

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

## Comprehension Questions

**1** Based on paragraph 2, what can the reader infer about the I-IV-V-I chord progression?

- |                                                                        |                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> It is too difficult for most professional musicians to play. | <b>B.</b> It is designed to make the listener feel confused and lost.             |
| <b>C.</b> It provides a sense of balance and completion to a song.     | <b>D.</b> It is only used when a songwriter has forgotten how to write new notes. |

**2** A student is editing a report about this article. Which sentence contains a spelling error that needs to be corrected?

- |                                                              |                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> The harmony in the song was very beautiful.        | <b>B.</b> We lissened to the guitar player perform a solo. |
| <b>C.</b> The teacher explained the chord progression today. | <b>D.</b> Country music is a popular style of art.         |

**3** What is the central idea of the article?

- |                                                                                      |                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> All country music is played on a steel guitar.                             | <b>B.</b> Chord progressions like I-IV-V-I provide the harmonic structure for most country music. |
| <b>C.</b> Roman numerals are the most important part of learning how to read a book. | <b>D.</b> Students should only use pianos when they play accompaniments.                          |

# Reading Comprehension Skills Continued

Read the passage, and then answer each question.

**4**

*This item has two parts. Answer Part A, then answer Part B.*

**Part A: According to the text, what is the purpose of the IV and V chords in a progression?**

- |                                                                        |                                                              |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> They make the song feel like it has reached a restful end.   | <b>B.</b> They create a “home” feeling for the listener.     |
| <b>C.</b> They create tension before the music returns to the I chord. | <b>D.</b> They are used to replace the melody of the singer. |

**Part B: Which sentence from the passage best supports the answer to Part A?**

- |                                                                                           |                                                                                                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>A.</b> “These Roman numerals represent the first, fourth, and fifth notes of a scale.” | <b>B.</b> “The IV and V chords create tension, and the final I chord brings the song back to a restful end.” |
| <b>C.</b> “They might use a guitar or a piano to play these three chords.”                | <b>D.</b> “In music class, students often create their own country-inspired accompaniments...”               |

**5**

**Retell how a I-IV-V-I progression works. Explain how a musician can use this knowledge to play along with a song as Country even if the song is unfamiliar. Be sure to use conventional spelling patterns for musical terms like chord and progression.**

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